JustFit v2: Long-Context Local LLM Serving with Just-in-Time State Management

Yuhua Chen
yuhuachen.com

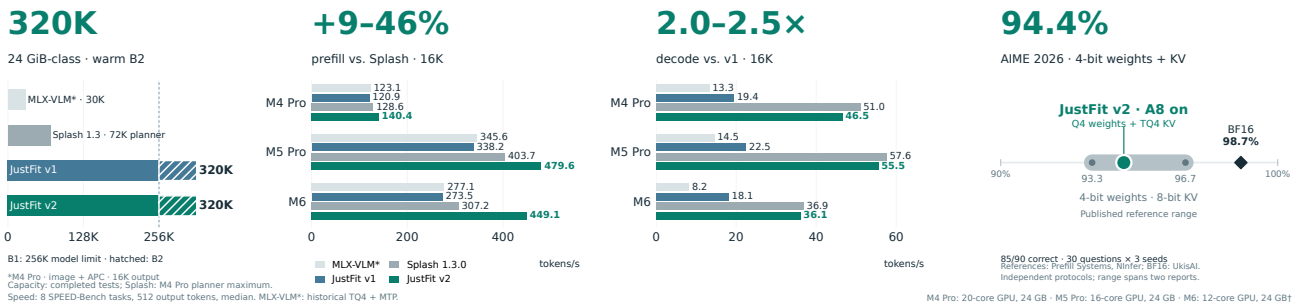


Figure 1. **Long-context, fast local AI on 24 GiB-class Macs.** JustFit v2 retains 256K single-request context and 320K aggregate two-request capacity with a resident speculative draft. At 16K input, prefill is 9–46% faster than Splash 1.3.0 and decode is 2.0–2.5× faster than JustFit v1. Four-bit weights and TurboQuant (TQ4) KV (Zandieh et al., 2026) achieve 94.4% on AIME 2026. Protocols and external accuracy references are detailed in Sections 4.1 and 5.3.

Abstract

Practical local inference is a foundational layer for personal and small-business AI: assistants and persistent agents need long context, responsive execution and continuity across interactions. JustFit v2 combines long-context capacity and faster execution for a four-bit 27B model on 24 GiB-class Macs. The system retains 256K positions in one request and reaches 320K aggregate page capacity across two warm-prefix requests while keeping its speculative draft resident. Across eight fixed-output 16K tasks on three Apple-silicon configurations, v2 delivers 2.0–2.5× v1's median decode rate. Prefill improves by 9–46% over Splash 1.3.0, with a 2–9% singleton-decode cost; four-request decode reaches 157.53 tokens/s at 1K on M5 Pro. We validate the execution changes from numerical references through paired reasoning, coding and multimodal tasks to integrated-service recovery. With four-bit weights, four-bit KV and activation-quantized execution, JustFit scores 94.4% on all 30 AIME 2026 questions at three seeds. Paired CPU-assisted and coding comparisons retain aggregate correct counts; detailed validation reports the observed activation-quantization and ANE vision differences. Four mechanisms enable these outcomes: representation-aware KVExec, phase-scoped residency in PhaseSwap, committed-state continuity in StateTrans, and CPU/GPU/ANE coordination in CrossFire. Together they make a capable local model a more practical foundation for applications on commodity hardware.

1. Introduction

Running a capable model locally is only useful when applications can rely on it. Assistants, document workflows and multimodal agents require a service that retains substantial context, responds interactively and sustains execution across requests and interruptions. Personal assistants must share resources with speech and visual processing; browser agents accumulate screenshots, tool results and task history; a small team may combine interactive requests with background work on one machine. These applications require an inference substrate that manages the complete workload within a fixed physical memory budget.

Loading the weights is only the beginning. Long histories, a speculative draft, recurrent state, image encoding and temporary workspaces must fit together. Optimizing their isolated peaks is insufficient when their lifetimes overlap. JustFit addresses this serving problem through coordinated representation, residency, committed-state management and heterogeneous execution.

Why just-in-time state management? JustFit applies a just-in-time principle to the inference live set: material-

[†]8 GiB locked on the 32 GiB M6 for capacity tests.
contact@yuhuachen.com · GitHub: justfit-llm.

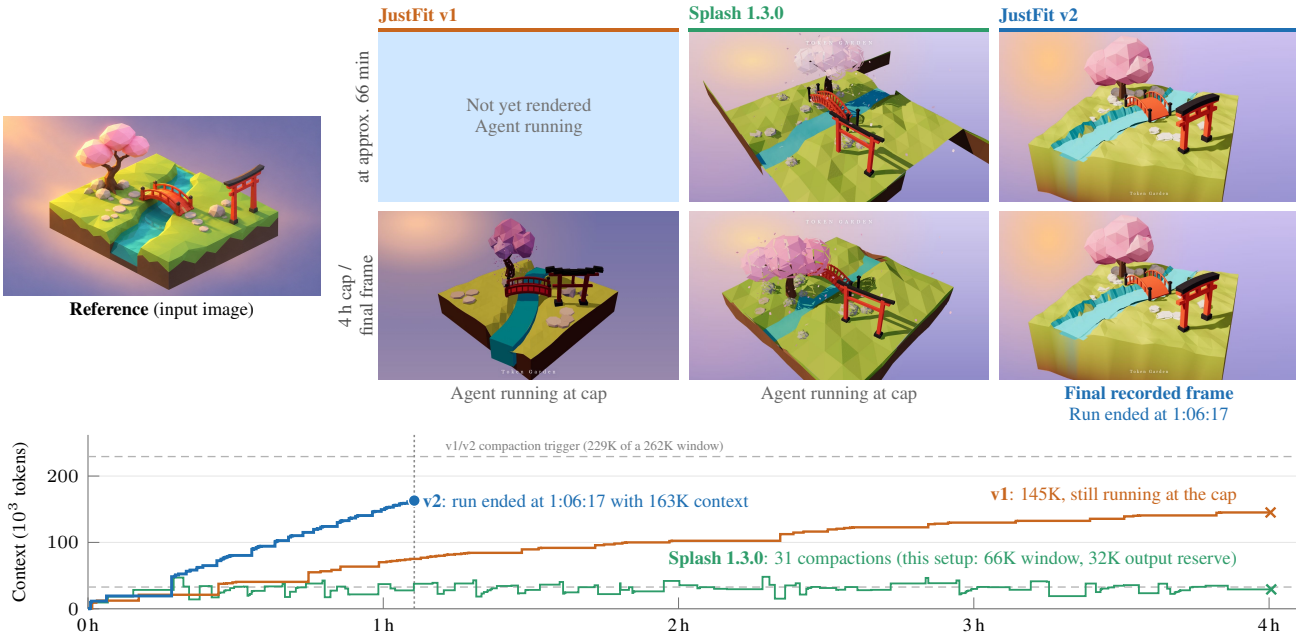


Figure 2. **A recorded coding-agent workflow on a 24 GiB M5 Pro.** The agent recreates the reference as a live Three.js scene. Top: common-time snapshots near 66 minutes; the second row shows v1/Splash at the four-hour cap and repeats v2's final recorded frame. Runs are sequential. V2's run ends at 1:06:17; the other agents remain active at the cap. Bottom: input-plus-output context after recorded model calls, in thousands of tokens. The vertical line marks v2's run end; dashed horizontal lines mark the configured compaction thresholds. Ending reflects the agent's decision, rather than a visual-quality score. Protocol details appear in Appendix K.

ize compute-ready state when needed, preserve reusable history compactly, and release temporary storage after its last consumer. Classical JIT compilation makes translation decisions during execution (Aycock, 2003); here the runtime decisions concern state representation and residency. Demand-driven tensor rematerialization offers a closer memory-management precedent (Kirisame et al., 2021), while modern inference systems combine paging, quantization, scheduling and persistence (Pan & Li, 2025). JustFit coordinates these established ideas around a hybrid model, a resident draft and shared CPU/GPU/ANE memory.

JustFit v1 established compressed-history execution and state-lifetime management in MLX (Chen, 2026; Hannun et al., 2023). V2 carries these principles into a native speculative runtime: it preserves long-context capacity while retaining the draft during concurrent generation, accelerates execution, and validates the changes through numerical references, paired tasks and service-recovery checks. Figures 1 and 2 summarize the system-level results and their application context.

The design builds on Splash 1.3.0, which supplies model-specialized Metal execution, DFlash2, language ANE FFN, paged KV storage and composite-state persistence (Inco AI, 2026a;b). Its evaluated four-bit target/draft package documented a 36 GB minimum and a 48 GB recommendation (Inco AI, 2026e;f). JustFit extends this foundation through four cooperating mechanisms:

- **KVExec** keeps compressed history compact at its consumers through page-native four-bit TurboQuant (TQ4), bounded reconstruction and rotated-domain execution.
- **PhaseSwap** bounds transient overlap through leases, mapped host embedding, shared arenas and a common verification-row budget, retaining the draft.
- **StateTrans** adapts v1's continuity policy to native speculation and extends upstream persistence with durable ancestor retention.
- **CrossFire** combines CPU/GPU partitioning and full-tower ANE vision with phase-aware resource admission and fallback.

Section 2 places the design in context. Section 3 develops the four components and their shared memory contract. Section 4 defines the experiments, and Section 5 evaluates capacity, speed, task quality and application behavior. Detailed derivations and supplemental measurements appear in the appendices.

2. Background and Related Work

Runtime memory decisions. Aycock surveys dynamic compilation and its runtime time–space tradeoffs (Aycock, 2003). DTR applies online eviction and recomputation to training tensors (Kirisame et al., 2021). These are conceptual precedents rather than implementation dependencies: JustFit manages persistent inference history and phase-local operands. The inference-systems survey of Pan & Li (2025) connects operator, scheduling and memory techniques; our focus is their coordination within a small unified-memory machine.

Local execution and committed state. JustFit v1 supplies KVExec, PhaseSwap, and StateTrans (Chen, 2026) on MLX, an array framework for Apple silicon (Hannun et al., 2023). V2 retains these principles while changing the runtime and concurrent speculative resident set. Splash supplies native execution, language ANE FFN, paged KV tiering and composite-state persistence; DFlash2 supplies the learned draft (Inco AI, 2026a;b). JustFit builds on these facilities with compressed-history consumers, residency controls, ancestor retention and coordinated vision execution. The baseline remains Splash 1.3.0; future JustFit releases will follow upstream updates such as 1.4 and 1.5 (Inco AI, 2026c;d). Gated Delta Networks (Yang et al., 2024) require the recurrent snapshot to accompany attention KV at a restore point.

Proposal generation. Target verification separates proposal generation from accepted output (Leviathan et al., 2023). Prompt Lookup Decoding reuses matching prompt substrings (Saxena, 2023); LLMA uses reference overlap (Yang et al., 2023); REST retrieves proposal tokens (He et al., 2024). Our context-tail implementation follows the HyperQwen lookup-augmented DFlash2 patch (syv-ai and HyperQwen contributors, 2026). JustFit integrates the learned prefix and lookup tail with adaptive width and a shared row budget.

KV compression and execution. KIVI studies asymmetric low-bit key/value quantization (Liu et al., 2024); KVQuant combines distribution-aware quantization with outlier handling (Hooper et al., 2024). QuaRot uses computational invariance for rotated low-bit inference (Ashkboos et al., 2024). TurboQuant studies compact rotated vector representations (Zandieh et al., 2026); KVExec additionally controls when and how stored operands are reconstructed for each consumer. PagedAttention manages serving pages (Kwon et al., 2023), while FlashAttention reduces attention IO (Dao et al., 2022). These address representation, allocation and IO; our contribution concerns their interaction with bounded consumers and a live draft on a shared physical budget.

Prefix reuse and service scheduling. RadixAttention in SGLang reuses shared prefix KV across calls (Zheng et al., 2024). CachedAttention retains conversation KV in a storage hierarchy, overlapping layer-wise preloading and asynchronous saves with computation (Gao et al., 2024). StateTrans addresses the composite boundary of a hybrid speculative model: target KV, recurrent state and draft context must resume the same committed prefix, including an ancestor retained after continuation. Orca introduces iteration-level scheduling (Yu et al., 2022), and Sarathi-Serve studies prefill/decode scheduling (Agrawal et al., 2024); layered prefill here additionally yields within a large token chunk. FlexGen exploits hierarchical storage (Sheng et al., 2023); on unified-memory devices, CPU mappings consume the same physical capacity. CrossFire combines accelerator execution with phase ownership and memory admission, building on ANE deployment techniques (Apple, 2022) and the credited oMLX arithmetic implementation (PowerSpy and oMLX contributors, 2026).

3. System Design

Figure 3 shows how the four components cooperate. KVExec determines the representation consumed by attention; PhaseSwap manages the lifetime of weights and temporary storage; StateTrans preserves the committed model state across scheduling and reuse; CrossFire places eligible work across CPU, GPU and ANE. A shared memory contract couples these decisions: an optimization is useful only if its compute-ready state fits alongside the other active consumers.

3.1. System Overview and Shared Memory Budget

The live set can be written as

$$M(t) = W_T(t) + W_D(t) + K(t) + S(t) + X(t) + V(t) + H(t), \quad (1)$$

where target and draft weights, retained KV, recurrent/speculative state, temporary workspaces, visual work, and host/allocator storage share physical unified memory. CPU mappings share this physical budget; SSD storage extends retained history between uses, while active attention consumes resident state.

The target interleaves 16 full-attention layers with 48 Gated DeltaNet layers (Yang et al., 2024). Each attention layer has four KV heads of dimension 256. TQ4 stores 128 bytes of indices and a two-byte norm per K or V vector, giving

$$\beta = 16 \times 2 \times 4 \times (128 + 2) = 16{,}640 \text{ B/token}. \quad (2)$$

FP16 KV would occupy 16 GiB at 256K retained positions, compared with 4,160 MiB of TQ4 payload. These figures exclude recurrent state, the draft, allocator effects, and execution workspaces.

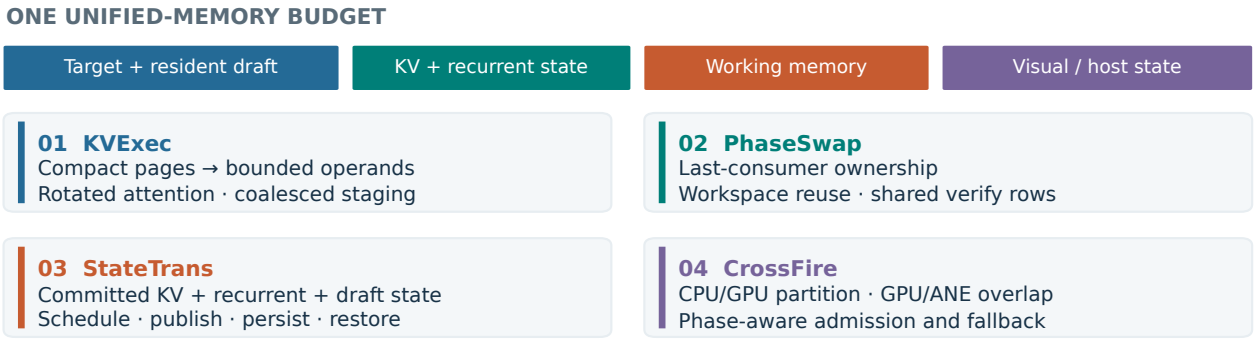


Figure 3. Four components, one memory budget. KVExec, PhaseSwap, and StateTrans extend v1's principles into a native speculative runtime. CrossFire adds heterogeneous execution. The four mechanisms coordinate the same live set through representation, residency, committed state and execution placement.

The evaluated native cache uses 32-token pages (532,480 bytes per page), unlike v1's 256-token pages. A single 128K chain already needs 2.03125 GiB of native KV payload, before its composite state and metadata. Full restoration also requires the corresponding composite state; Section 5.7 evaluates its retention.

3.2. KVExec: Execute in the Right Representation

3.2.1. From v1 to Native Pages

V1 used TurboQuant's normalized rotated MSE representation, page-addressed reconstruction, and stock floating attention consumers. Fusing page lookup, unpacking, centroid reconstruction, inverse rotation, and norm restoration avoided a sequence of temporary packed and floating arrays. Explicit evaluation prevented lazy operands from surviving across many layers. Later v1 head grouping reconstructed two of four KV heads at a time.

V2 integrates compact pages with the native allocator and Metal command graph. Decode and short verification consume packed history; long prefill reconstructs a K/V head into a BF16 staging plane and reuses it across query tiles. At 256K history, one head's K/V pair is 256 MiB; staging all four together would require 1,024 MiB. Explicit dependencies complete the old reader before that plane is reused by another head or layer. This calculation bounds the attention operand; process-level measurements include the rest of the live set.

3.2.2. Rotated-Domain Attention

Orthogonal-transform invariance is an established tool for low-bit inference, exemplified by QuaRot (Ashkboos et al., 2024). Our stored representation follows TurboQuant; the execution contribution is to select and implement the appropriate consumer of that representation. Let the stored reconstructed key be $\widehat{k}_t = R_K^{\mathsf{T}} k'_t$, where R_K is orthogonal and k'_t includes centroid and norm reconstruction in the stored domain. With a separate value transform R_V,

$$\alpha_t = \mathrm{softmax}_t\left((R_K q)^{\mathsf{T}} k'_t/\sqrt{d} + m_t\right), \tag{3}$$

$$o = R_V^{\mathsf{T}} \sum_t \alpha_t v'_t. \tag{4}$$

The query rotates once and the weighted output returns once. The implementation avoids undoing the transform for every historical vector. Staged-head prefill and rotated verification are complementary choices: the former amortizes reconstructed operands over many query tiles, while the latter changes the domain of a short query's traversal.

The numerical validation follows the transformation from operator to model: identical-input references check low-precision arithmetic, fixed-prefix full-vocabulary comparisons check logits, and paired tasks check model outcomes. The cycle-time measurements appear in Appendix B.5.

3.2.3. Layout-Aware Kernels

The coalesced V path changes the mapping from compressed token-major codewords to dimension-major staging. Adjacent lanes write adjacent token positions instead of widely separated addresses. Its selected comparison preserves the arithmetic and codebook. Appendix B.5 evaluates the resulting throughput change.

The layout issue can be expressed without changing the quantizer. Let the staging plane be $V[d, t]$ with token stride one. Threads traversing d at a fixed t write addresses separated by the history length, whereas threads traversing t at fixed d write adjacent locations. Reassigning the reconstruction work to match the latter pattern changes transaction organization while retaining the same centroids, norms and output elements. The consumer's head/dimension mapping must remain consistent. Byte comparisons and unchanged acceptance distinguish this layout intervention from a precision change.

A separate compact softmax adapts upstream Page32 thread organization to staged TQ4 attention. Tile shape, query reuse, and barrier cost are evaluated rather than inferred from instruction count. Appendix C summarizes the mechanisms and measured alternatives.

Appendix A gives the codec derivation, page addressing and consumer contracts.

3.3. PhaseSwap: Residency with a Live Draft

3.3.1. Last-Consumer Ownership

PhaseSwap organizes the phase-local live set, keeping the speculative draft resident while bounding temporary overlap. In v1, an untied LM head (644.14 MiB in the archived layout) could detach during intermediate prefill but had to return before logits. A generation owner retained the head through mixed prefill and decode. Vision used a separate media lease: encode, evaluate embeddings, and release the tower before ordinary text prefill. The singleton MTP predictor was released when the system switched to concurrent AR.

V2 retains target and draft during the studied concurrent mode. A mapped host-embedding gather reduces Metal residency without changing the unified-memory budget. Visual weights and optional prefill storage are admitted when needed. Nonoverlapping GDN packed/hidden workspaces share backing with later staging users; a separately measured arena change reduced allocation by 89 MiB. Packed and hidden storage remain separate when the gate simultaneously reads one and writes the other. Decode-owned RoPE constants survive the release of prefill-only arenas.

Elastic workspace releases prefill storage at its last consumer. Its initial isolated screen left capacity and throughput unchanged, illustrating the role of the limiting phase: a local allocation reduction helps the whole workload only when it reduces the peak live set.

Ownership lasts through asynchronous completion, not merely host submission. Appendix A gives the lease invariants and safe-aliasing conditions.

3.3.2. Bounded Verification Rows

Concurrency and speculation share a row budget. The shared-row design enforces

$$br \le 32, \qquad r \in \{8, 16\}. \tag{5}$$

A full B4 cohort uses eight rows per lane; B1/B2 can use sixteen. Scratch is sized by packed rows and lifetimes rather than reserving sixteen rows independently for every lane. Section A.3 explains proposal selection and adaptive width; Appendix B.5 evaluates the workspace–throughput tradeoff.

3.4. StateTrans: Preserve Committed Progress

3.4.1. Admission, Scheduling, and Mode Changes

StateTrans preserves the committed boundary when the active cohort changes: recurrent state and draft context must remain aligned with KV. V1 distinguished queue arrival from admission. It reserved prompt pages plus a bounded output allowance, tracked shared-prefix references, and converted MTP to AR only at a completed round. Completion and cancellation first evaluated pending work, filtered departing rows, and then released page references. Generation-bound owner identities prevented an old finalizer from releasing a newer cohort's lease.

Native v2 applies the same continuity principle with a different resident set. Layered prefill retains a large arithmetic chunk while executing it in layer ranges. Intermediate state survives between ranges, and incumbent decode receives scheduling opportunities between slices. This differs from merely shrinking the token chunk. Evaluation reports incumbent decode, new-prompt prefill, and chat TTFT separately; the historical study improved the first two while increasing short-chat TTFT.

The lookup extension follows HyperQwen's lookup-augmented DFlash2 implementation (syv-ai and HyperQwen contributors, 2026; Inco AI, 2026a): it extends the learned proposal only when the heads agree, and target verification decides the committed output. Width adapts to recent accepted work within the shared row budget. Appendix A.3 gives the decision rule and useful-work criterion.

3.4.2. Composite Publication and Persistence

Prefix reuse and hierarchical conversation caching are established by SGLang and CachedAttention (Zheng et al., 2024; Gao et al., 2024). KV alone cannot resume this hybrid speculative model. A reusable point contains target KV, GDN state, and the draft context required at the committed boundary. Decode-end snapshots publish generated history after the tentative window is committed. Paged persistence shares chain segments; immutable state and page references survive until their transfers finish. Resource pressure can prevent publication even when the request itself completes.

V1's synchronous disk-only snapshot borrowed page-run views instead of materializing the whole packed cache. Its single-pass writer forwarded bounded payloads to an atomic destination. Native v2 uses Splash 1.3.0's existing paged KV tier, composite-state disk storage, and restoration framework. The publication and transfer ordering described here are inherited correctness requirements. JustFit extends the retention policy to preserve superseded restore points whose KV chains reach 32,768 tokens. A later state does not generally reconstruct the recurrent state of an earlier branch point,

a distinction exposed by the restart study below.

Appendix A gives transition ordering, demand-allocated persistence staging and layer-slice ownership.

3.5. CrossFire: Heterogeneous Execution

3.5.1. CPU/GPU Partition and Arithmetic Selection

CrossFire coordinates established heterogeneous execution capabilities under one physical budget (Apple, 2022; Inco AI, 2026b). Its contribution is the numerical adaptation and phase-aware integration of these paths with ongoing text service. Intra-prefill CPU/GPU execution partitions projection columns. On M4 Pro, the selected CPU-SME path uses GPU-matched arithmetic and a bounded CPU fraction; the evaluated profile specifies 0.16 with eight threads. Earlier 0.20 or 0.33 studies are distinct from that evaluated recipe.

On M5 Pro, selective W4A8 prefill and target-verification FFN use hardware INT8 opportunities; the implementation follows the register-decoding approach credited to oMLX (PowerSpy and oMLX contributors, 2026). Prefill and verify switches are separate. Historical operator measurements found the studied M4 Pro INT8 path did not provide the M5 Pro advantage, so profile selection is device-specific. A8 means activation quantization and is distinct from ANE execution.

The inherited Splash language-FFN ANE path is a third execution form. Our integration concerns phase buffers, coexistence, retention/release, and numerical characterization. M6 enables this path in its selected profile. Its numerical behavior and history dependence are evaluated separately from the vision tower.

3.5.2. Complete ANE Vision Tower

CrossFire also moves supported vision encoding off a busy GPU. The full 27-layer vision tower is executed as nine groups with actual full-ANE/no-GPU placement checks. Authoring uses fixed capacity tiers and runtime position/mask inputs. M4 Pro and M5 Pro historical studies compiled 4K, 8K, and 14.4K variants; an oversized tier can waste work on padding even when the logical image is small.

The numerical work is part of the contribution. Equivalent LayerNorm range conditioning addresses measured variance overflow; explicit original GELU expressions and attention probability–value scaling address additional low-precision errors. These preserve model weights and real-arithmetic definitions. Device-local placement, memory metering, worker ownership, cancellation, and recovery supplement embedding comparisons (Apple, 2022).

The aligned M5 Pro recipe is evaluated on one recorded image per 4K, 8K and 14.4K tier. Table 8 in Appendix A reports encoder time and FP32-relative embedding error for these distinct inputs.

3.5.3. Routing and Service Objectives

Text decoding for an image answer still uses the GPU; language prefill can additionally use ANE on M6. Routing must therefore consider the whole request and its peers, not just encoder speed. For image arrival a and completion times c_I, c_T, image latency is $c_I - a$, remaining text latency is $c_T - a$, and remaining makespan is $\max(c_I, c_T) - a$. The sum of waiting times is a different metric.

Historical routing experiments used measured tier costs and forced diagnostic routes to study overlap. The completed service instead qualifies ready 4K/8K tiers using execution phase, queue state, worker/payload leases, and current memory admission. These tier sizes count raw patches, not display pixels or language tokens. M4 Pro/M5 Pro permit vision ANE during GPU text prefill and decode. M6 additionally uses upstream ANE FFN execution for language prefill. JustFit adds phase-scoped buffer release and safe-point coordination with vision ownership, so its vision policy permits decode-only overlap with no active prefill; image encoding stays on GPU during language prefill. Ownership and safe-point coordination serialize access to the shared accelerator. A slowdown by itself is not evidence of simultaneous conflicting ANE execution.

Idle or unknown phase, unsupported geometry or multi-image cases, queue contention, and denied memory can select GPU. Larger compiled tiers remain historical experiments rather than default serving policy. The policy uses phase and memory admission rather than predicting request latency. Appendix B.9 distinguishes functional qualification of this policy from the historical forced-route interference measurements.

Appendix A gives execution synchronization, graph geometry and numerical conditioning.

4. Experimental Setup

Platforms and configurations. M4 Pro has a 20-core GPU and 24 GiB of physical memory; M5 Pro has a 16-core GPU and 24 GiB; M6 has a 12-core GPU and 32 GiB. The earlier native batch matrices and 16K speed cohort use a 21,631 MiB native allocation setting, a separate 128 MiB host-headroom threshold, and a 22,015 MiB owned-process-group physical-memory guard. The later warm B2 capacity cohort uses a 22,015 MiB native budget and demand-allocated persistence staging; its host and guard protocol is recorded with that cohort. V1 uses a 21,000 MiB group guard. These limits account for different resources: native allocations, host headroom and sampled process-group

footprint. Device names identify the complete evaluated configurations in Table 1; K denotes 1,024 positions unless stated otherwise. M4 Pro uses CPU-SME fraction 0.16 with eight threads and disables W4A8, lookup and language-model ANE. M5 Pro enables prefill/verify W4A8 and lookup. M6 additionally enables language-model ANE. Prefix reuse is enabled in the batch matrices; the stock-speed controls use fresh processes and disable candidate prefix reuse. Persistence comparisons change restore-point retention in separately identified builds.

Whole-stack baseline. Stock is upstream Splash 1.3.0 with INT8 KV, language ANE disabled and a 21,631 MiB native memory limit. The paired candidate uses TQ4 KV and its device-specific settings; model and prompt identities are frozen in the manifests. In this earlier 1K/32K cohort, stock retains a fixed 2,048 MiB host reserve on both M4 Pro and M5 Pro and reports a 20,992 MiB hard budget; the candidate uses a 128 MiB host reserve. The comparison therefore covers representation, allocation policy, effective admission budgets and execution settings together. Paired PP trials have identical input-token counts and frozen prompts; generated trajectories and stop lengths vary. All 48 successful M4 Pro stock requests record the same 2,048 MiB reserve; startup retries preserve it. The separate 16K cohort in Section 4.1 uses a reduced M4 Pro reserve. At M5 Pro 1K, stock/candidate arms reach the 1,024-token cap in 18/21 of 24 trials, respectively.

Batch throughput. We use two nominal input buckets (1K and 32K), eight fixed fixtures, three repeats and widths B1/B2/B4: 144 cohorts per device, or 24 per cell. Actual prompt lengths vary by fixture. Generation uses natural EOS and a 1,024-token cap. A barrier holds decode until all cohort prompts are ready. We report the arithmetic mean of per-cohort native aggregate decode rates, including the shrinking tail. Observed min–max whiskers show workload dispersion. All three matrices are complete. The M4 Pro matrix uses the pre-repair common source, identified separately from the later persistence build; its 144 launch records configure CPU prefill at fraction 0.16 with eight threads, with W4A8 and lookup disabled. CPU partitioning applies to eligible prefill operations. Additional storage settings are recorded in Appendix B.

Image interference. The M5 Pro diagnostic starts one or three 32K text lanes, releases their decode barrier, and then submits an image. No-image, GPU-image, and forced-ANE-image arms use three rotated-order repeats. The image makes total concurrency B2 or B4. We measure the largest text delivery-event gap in the 30-second arrival window, image latency, and full text-cohort wall time. Delivery events may contain multiple tokens. The 8K and 14.4K visual tiers share the same no-image control. Forced routing and actual execution device are recorded separately.

Task quality. Task comparisons retain their paired prompts, sampling settings, and output limits. M4 Pro uses 15 selected AIME questions and 30 questions each from MMLU-Pro and LiveCodeBench (LCB). M5 Pro evaluates the full 30-question AIME 2026 set at three seeds, giving 90 generations per A8 arm with the same four-bit target weights and TQ4 KV; it also uses a separate 24-question LCB subset with a 32K output cap. Seed repeats are not additional independent questions. Vision uses 30 MMMU-Pro questions containing 34 images; only questions actually encoded on ANE support ANE task-quality comparisons. The remaining selected subsets serve as paired regression probes.

Restart protocol. A writer submits history H, repeats H, and submits a continuation H′. A fresh engine then requests H and H′; an additional control reverses that fresh-process order. We record cached/recomputed tokens, disk-KV reads, recurrent-state hits, time to first token (TTFT), and output equality. Disk reads are attributed per request: a second request can reuse pages already restored by the first.

4.1. Four-System Fixed-Output Protocol

Figure 1 compares the historical MLX-VLM (TQ4+MTP) configuration, JustFit v1, upstream Splash 1.3.0 and JustFit v2. We freeze eight real code tasks in source order from the low-entropy block, excluding placeholder-only rows, in the official SPEED-Bench `throughput_16k/test` split (NVIDIA, 2026) before inspecting outputs. Each request generates exactly 512 tokens with greedy sampling and medium thinking, EOS and custom-stop termination disabled, and zero prompt-cache hits. Actual inputs span 17,053–18,253 tokens. PP divides input tokens by client TTFT; TG uses the 511 intervals after the first generated token. Medians summarize the eight tasks, not repeated trials of one prompt. Different numerical paths can produce different token trajectories; fixed lengths equalize output work, not semantic content or quality.

The MLX-VLM* speed arm is a historical modified snapshot using MXFP4 weights, four-bit TurboQuant KV and an MTP draft. JustFit v1 also uses MXFP4 weights, TQ4 KV and MTP; Splash/v2 use packed Q4 and DFlash. M4 Pro Splash uses a 1 GiB host reserve after original-default startup failures; M5 Pro/M6 retain the 2 GiB upstream reserve. Failed starts are retained outside completed trials. The original four-arm cohort contains 96 requests. A subsequent alternating old/new v2 runtime check contributes 16 requests per device; all 24 paired outputs match and median PP/TG changes remain within 1%. Figure 1 uses that refreshed v2 cohort. Speed runs use 21,631 MiB internally; a one-prompt-per-arm sanity check at 22,015 MiB yields

Table 1. Earlier batch-matrix configuration dimensions (the batch-throughput study). The native allocation limit is 21,631 MiB, host reserve 128 MiB, and owned-group guard 22,015 MiB. Historical mechanism experiments use the explicitly described local settings.

Device	GPU cores	Physical GiB	CPU fraction / threads	Prefill / verify A8	Context lookup	Language ANE
M4 Pro	20	24	0.16 / 8	Off / off	Off	Off
M5 Pro	16	24	0	On / on	On	Off
M6	12	32	0	On / on	On	On

Table 2. Metric definitions used throughout the evaluation. A result is compared only within the same denominator and timing scope.

Metric	Definition and interpretation
Client-visible PP	Original input tokens divided by TTFT; recomputed rows do not inflate the numerator.
Native aggregate TG	Runtime-reported aggregate generated-token rate per cohort; includes the cohort tail under the stated protocol.
Common-active TG	Generated work during the interval when all intended decode lanes are active.
Client-visible TG	Generated tokens divided by the client generation interval; distinct from native kernel timing.
Maximum / p99 delivery gap	Gaps between observed stream delivery events in the specified window; events may contain multiple tokens.
Image latency	Image completion minus its own arrival; excludes preceding time spent by already-active requests.
Physical peak	Sampled footprint for the owned process group; can miss short peaks or double-count shared pages.
Metal allocation	Runtime allocation accounting; excludes some host and external accelerator-service storage.
Restore evidence	Cached/recomputed tokens, disk-KV reads and composite-state hits attributed to each cold or warm request.

equal outputs on all devices.

5. Evaluation

We evaluate three central outcomes—retained context, execution speed and task quality—then examine the application workflow and the mechanisms that support sustained service.

5.1. Retained Context

Both JustFit generations reach the model's 256K single-request context limit and 320K aggregate B2 capacity; v2 retains its speculative draft. Figure 1 summarizes capacity: the MLX-VLM configuration completes 30K with an image and automatic prefix caching (APC) on M4 Pro, while the JustFit tests measure warm text capacity (Appendix B.2). Splash 1.3.0's planner reports 73,721 tokens (approximately 72K) on M4 Pro with INT8 KV, a 21,400 MiB configured limit and 1 GiB host headroom (20,992 MiB hard budget); this is a planner maximum, not a completed 72K request. B1 includes input and generated positions; B2 is an aggregate over two live requests. JustFit v1 completes $(160\text{K}+16\text{K})+(128\text{K}+16\text{K})$ with ordered warm prefixes under a 21,000 MiB process-group guard. V2 completes $(128\text{K}+32\text{K})\times 2$ with a 22,015 MiB native budget and demand-allocated persistence staging; its draft remains resident. Both therefore reach a 320K page capacity, with distinct initialization and output shapes. V1's nearest final simultaneous logical sample is 327,677 positions (three below 327,680); its page high-water mark reaches 327,680. This is warm aggregate capacity across two live requests.

M4 Pro and M5 Pro have physical 24 GiB. M6 has physical 32 GiB; its final v1/v2 B2 tests reserve and lock 8 GiB, with compression and swap permitted in the remaining memory. M6 speed runs use the full physical configuration.

5.2. Single-Request Speed and Concurrent Throughput

At 16K, median decode rises from 19.4 to 46.5 tokens/s on M4 Pro, 22.5 to 55.5 on M5 Pro, and 18.1 to 36.1 on M6: gains of 2.39×, 2.47× and 1.99× over v1. V2 improves median PP relative to Splash by 9.2%, 18.8% and 46.2% on M4 Pro, M5 Pro and M6, respectively. Median TG changes by -8.8%, -3.6% and -2.2%. The context-oriented configuration thus pairs faster prefill with a modest singleton-decode cost in this fixed-output workload.

Figure 1 presents the four-system comparison; Appendix E lists the exact prefill and decode medians.

5.2.1. Batch Throughput and Matched Controls

Concurrency raises aggregate decode on M5 Pro and M6 while revealing a different scaling regime on M4 Pro (Figure 5). At 32K, M5 Pro grows from 56.84 to 83.84 to 111.28 tokens/s for B1/B2/B4; M6 grows from 34.58 to 56.60 to 81.30. Their B4 rates are about twice the singleton rate or more. M4 Pro changes from 40.92 to 43.32 to 43.12 tokens/s at 32K, and from 58.03 to 61.10 to 60.35 at 1K, yielding B4/B1 ratios of 1.054 and 1.040. Counter decomposition

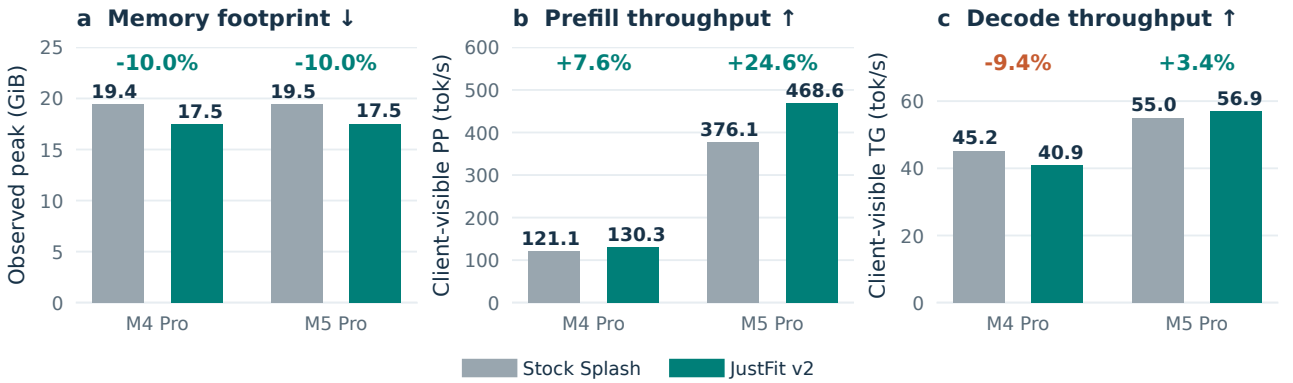


Figure 4. Memory and speed at 32K input on two 24 GiB systems, using the same 27B model package. Stock Splash and JustFit v2 are compared over 24 trials per arm and device (eight fixtures, three repeats). Memory is the maximum observed request-phase physical peak; PP and TG are arithmetic means of client-visible rates. Percentages compare those displayed summaries, not the mean of paired percentage changes. JustFit reduces the observed memory peak on both devices and improves PP; M4 Pro TG regresses while M5 Pro TG improves modestly. The whole-stack controls include KV format, execution settings and effective admission budgets.

in Appendix B relates this plateau to cycle-cost growth that nearly offsets additional useful output.

All three matrices contain 144 cohorts with accepted synchronization barriers and no recorded physical-memory guard trip. B1 native-prefill means at 1K/32K are 146.20/129.95 tokens/s on M4 Pro, 553.29/471.07 on M5 Pro and 444.44/403.75 on M6, computed from executed input tokens and native prefill wall time with zero matched prompt tokens. Prefill and fixed-width decode are both lower at 32K than at 1K on each device. These native rates exclude client and first-token overhead; the stock controls below use client-visible timing.

B1/B2 record no matched prompt tokens. B4 records 3,840/115,072 matched tokens at nominal 1K/32K on M5 Pro and 3,840/171,072 on both M4 Pro and M6. The difference arises from a shared 28,000-token fixture prefix that is reused in more repeats on M4 Pro/M6. The fixture set is the same. These observations document within-cohort prefix sharing. M4 Pro's maximum measured process-group footprint is 19.71 GiB across this matrix.

The stock controls show a consistent prefill benefit and workload-sensitive singleton decode. M5 Pro's mean decode rises by 8.20% at 1K and 3.42% at 32K (Table 3), whereas the fixed-output 16K cohort in Figure 1 falls by 3.6%. The sign change is compatible with the protocols: different prompts and context lengths, natural EOS versus fixed 512-token output, and means versus medians. Both measure client-visible speed; the native batch bars use a separate timing definition. These observations therefore describe different operating points of the same system.

The paired analysis in Appendix B (Table 9) leaves M5 Pro's positive mean decode changes tentative and documents M4 Pro's 9.45% 32K decode regression; full cycle accounting is reported there.

5.3. Quality Validated from Operators to Tasks

We evaluate task quality: whether the optimized system retains reasoning, coding and visual question-answering capability. Table 4 reports the paired task outcomes. Operator-level validation in Appendix B.6 separately measures compression distortion, additional kernel arithmetic error and fixed-history model behavior; integrated-service checks appear in Appendix B.9. Table 5 connects these layers.

Full-set AIME 2026. With identical four-bit target weights and TQ4 KV, M5 Pro scores **86/90 (95.6%)** with A8 off and **85/90 (94.4%)** with A8 on across all 30 AIME 2026 questions at three seeds. Both arms have three output-capped generations, included in the denominator as unsuccessful attempts. A8 thus retains strong mathematical reasoning with a one-answer difference in this paired evaluation, which isolates activation quantization within the quantized configuration. A8 denotes eight-bit activations; it is separate from Apple Neural Engine (ANE) execution. Figure 1 reports the A8-on configuration used for the M5 Pro serving profile, rather than the slightly higher A8-off control.

The paired runs use the EvalScope AIME prompt, a 98,304-token output cap, temperature 1.0, top-p 0.95, top-k 20 and `xhigh` reasoning effort. Three seeds cover the full set with matched arm settings; Appendix B records seeds, batch scheduling and arm order.

Context from independent evaluations. Published Qwen3.8-27B evaluations provide a useful reference for the retained reasoning capability. NInfer reports 96.67% (29/30) with NVFP4 weights and INT8 KV through EvalScope,

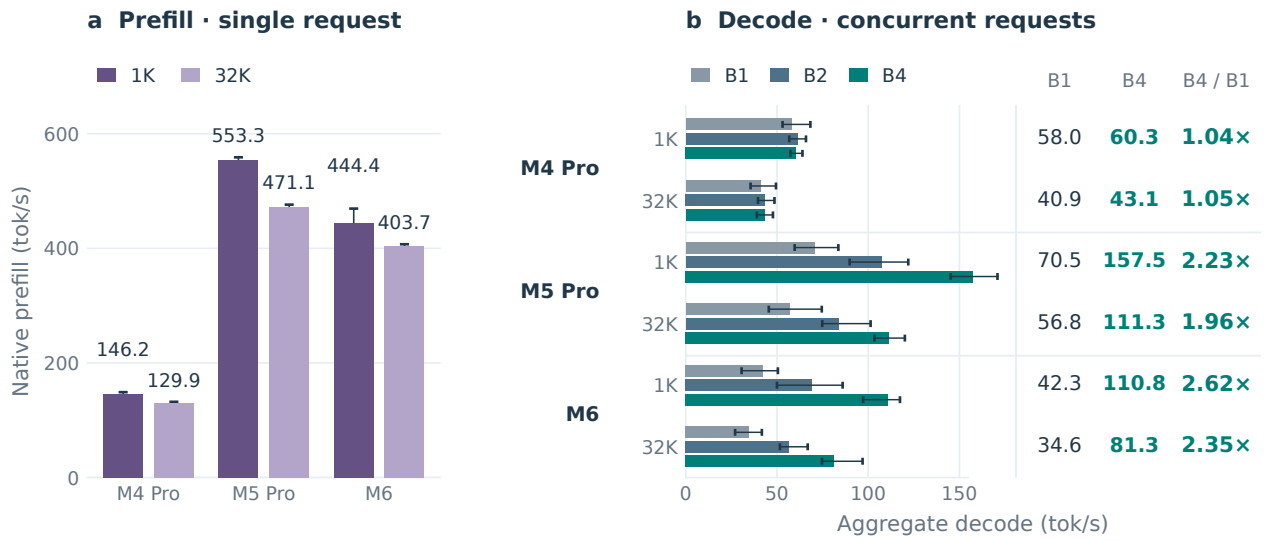


Figure 5. Context length and concurrent throughput in the same native experiment. Left: adjacent 1K/32K bars show B1 native prefill per device. Right: each context has B1/B2/B4 aggregate-decode bars; aligned columns give the B1 and B4 means (tokens/s) and their B4/B1 ratio. Exact B2 means are retained in the complete throughput table. Every bar is a mean of 24 cohorts; whiskers show observed min–max, not confidence intervals. Device profiles are listed in Table 1; native timing is defined in Table 2.

Table 3. Matched client-visible prefill (PP) and decode (TG), tokens/s; 24 trials per arm and bucket. These whole-stack controls have a different timing definition from Figure 5.

Device	Input	Stock PP	JustFit PP	Change	Stock TG	JustFit TG	Change
M4 Pro	1K	132.18	142.72	+7.98%	56.43	57.22	+1.40%
M4 Pro	32K	121.05	130.27	+7.61%	45.20	40.93	-9.45%
M5 Pro	1K	422.04	524.55	+24.29%	65.54	70.92	+8.20%
M5 Pro	32K	376.13	468.62	+24.59%	55.02	56.90	+3.42%

using a 122,880-token output cap (NInfer contributors, 2026a;b). Prefill Systems reports 93.3% with NVFP4 weights and FP8 E4M3 KV, using a 65,536-token output cap (Prefill Systems, 2026). JustFit's 94.4% falls between these two reported scores while also reducing KV precision to four bits. The BF16 reference in Figure 1 is UkisAI's 98.67% measurement of the unmodified base model, across five seeds with a 250,000-token output cap (UkisAI, 2026). These independent protocols place JustFit in the context of published results; the matched A8 comparison above measures the effect of our activation-quantized execution directly.

For the control/treatment columns, M4 Pro compares GPU/CPU-assisted execution on text tasks and GPU/ANE vision on MMMU-Pro; M5 Pro compares stock/JustFit on LCB, A8 off/on on AIME, and GPU/ANE vision on MMMU-Pro. Table 4 distinguishes the full-set AIME result from the selected task probes. M6's GPU AIME subset has 14 correct and one capped answer among 15; separate language-ANE on/off probes each pass four coding and eight retrieval cases. The task sets differ across devices.

Table 4. Full-set AIME 2026 and task probes: correct / capped or ungraded. M5 Pro AIME covers all 30 questions at three seeds (90 generations per arm); M4 Pro MMMU-Pro covers 29 selected actual-ANE questions at three seeds (87 attempts per arm); other rows use selected probes. Arm totals can agree despite different per-question outputs.

Device	Task (n)	Control	Treatment
M4 Pro	AIME (15)	14 / 1	14 / 1
M4 Pro	MMLU-Pro (30)	27 / 0	27 / 0
M4 Pro	LCB (30)	25 / 3	25 / 3
M5 Pro	LCB (24)	17 / 7	17 / 7
M5 Pro	AIME26 full (90)	86 / 3	85 / 3
M5 Pro	MMMU-Pro (29)	26 / 0	24 / 0
M4 Pro	MMMU-Pro (87)	75 / 0	75 / 0

The matched CPU and coding arms preserve aggregate task scores. A8 differs by one correct answer across 90 AIME generations. A subsequent three-seed M4 Pro vision comparison gives **75/87 correct (86.2%) for both GPU and ANE** on 29 selected MMMU-Pro questions: four discordant attempts favor each arm. Thus the repeated M4 Pro test

shows no aggregate accuracy deficit from ANE vision in this cohort (Appendix B.7). The earlier M5 Pro single-seed result remains 26/29 versus 24/29 under its own protocol. Together these results support retained task capability while exposing per-question variation. Appendix B records the numerical measurements and per-device protocols; Section 6 discusses remaining coverage.

Connecting operator error to task outcomes. The supporting operator study separates compression distortion from implementation error: across six fixed-input attention sets, additional native arithmetic error is 0.165–0.175%, compared with 4.34–8.53% intrinsic attention-output distortion from compression. Appendix B.6 explains the reference construction; Appendix B.7 gives the repeated vision protocol. These complementary checks connect the execution mechanisms to the task outcomes rather than treating numerical agreement alone as task accuracy.

5.4. From Serving Improvements to an Agent Workflow

Figure 2 connects these system results to a visual coding task on one 24 GiB M5 Pro. Given the same reference image, prompt and tools, a coding agent builds a live Three.js garden. The recorded v2 run ends after approximately 66 minutes with 163,038 tokens of retained context and no history compaction. At the same elapsed time, v1's page has not yet rendered and Splash is still revising its scene. V1 and Splash continue to the four-hour cap; Splash performs 31 history compactions, while v1 retains its history without compaction. The paired snapshots make the application-visible progress concrete; the timeline shows the different context trajectories. Appendix K records the agent settings, complete-system differences and run-end definition.

5.5. Historical Native Development Progression

The development chain shows how execution changes recover the cost of compressed storage. Introducing TQ4 first reduces allocation and slows both rates; later representation-aware kernels and workspace changes recover throughput while keeping the smaller live set. Recorded outputs are identical across stages, with zero prefix-cache hits and no resource suspension or replay. Separate studies evaluate scheduling, CPU/ANE execution and lookup (Appendix B.5).

5.6. CrossFire: Continuity versus Image Latency

For the 8K tier, GPU image processing increases the median maximum text delivery gap from 0.107 to 1.702 seconds; ANE offload reduces it to 0.425 seconds. At 14.4K, GPU and ANE gaps are approximately 3.51 and 0.40 seconds. Image latency rises from 8.54 to 13.15 seconds at 8K and from approximately 15.7 to 23.1 seconds at 14.4K (Figure 7). CrossFire therefore trades image completion time for continuity of the incumbent text stream in these one-lane workloads. Recorded ANE preparation takes 6.21–6.33 s at 8K and 15.49–15.58 s at 14.4K, with approximately 6.9–7.7 s remaining until image completion. Median preparation is about 73% and 99% of the corresponding GPU arm's entire image latency. These cross-arm ratios describe the harness intervals; Appendix G retains the full timing ranges.

Admission limits the result under higher concurrency. With three incumbent text lanes, some nominal ANE attempts fall back to GPU. One original GPU control overlaps background compilation and is unsuitable for a clean comparison. In a separate set of five uncontaminated B4 control records, both requested ANE routes encode zero images on ANE; the 8K record is retained inside a failed assertion payload, and the 14.4K attempt is denied its memory lease. These attempts document admission fallback rather than executed ANE throughput.

Twelve loopback HTTP requests exercise GPU/policy routing for 8K and 14.4K images. All content checks pass, reservations return to zero, and disconnect/recovery succeeds. For the long-prefill cases, text wall changes from 79.54 to 78.29 seconds at 8K and from 83.96 to 81.62 at 14.4K, while image latency increases. Each shape/arm has one observation, so this is a lifecycle and routing test rather than a sustained-service result.

A separate three-pair M4 Pro CPU/GPU/ANE coexistence study reduces mean total wall from 308.964 to 287.077 seconds (7.08%) with essentially unchanged decode rate. The measurement covers the combined CPU/GPU/ANE configuration.

5.7. Restoring Composite History

The cache can omit an ancestor state when exactly one child subtree contains an ordinary state. Its KV chain can remain on disk even though the recurrent state needed to resume that ancestor is absent. We evaluate a retention rule that preserves such restore points when the stored chain is at least 32,768 tokens long.

For the M5 Pro 128K history, retaining the state restores 131,040 tokens, recomputes 32, and reduces TTFT from 445.38 to 1.90 seconds. The corresponding M6 pair changes from 582.91 to 1.86 seconds with the same restored token count (Figure 8). Output equality is checked separately from semantic answer correctness.

The integrated service also restores 34,464 disk KV tokens and one composite-state snapshot on each of the three devices, with outputs matching the preparation run. Additional request-order and eviction controls separate cold recovery from in-process reuse (Appendix B).

Table 5. Validation connects the optimized operator to the complete serving path. Task outcomes appear in Table 4; numerical references and lifecycle measurements are collected in Appendix B.

Layer	Comparison	Recorded evidence
Compressed KV	Codec reference, higher-precision attention, fixed-history replay	Separates intrinsic compression distortion from additional arithmetic error across six captured attention sets.
CPU and A8	GPU/CPU tasks; matched four-bit/TQ4 A8 off/on	M4 Pro mathematics, knowledge and code; M5 Pro full AIME at three seeds.
ANE vision	GPU/ANE embeddings and graded MMMU-Pro answers	Full-tower placement and tier coverage; M4 Pro GPU/ANE both 75/87 over three seeds, M5 Pro 26/29 versus 24/29 at one seed.
Language ANE	M6 on/off coding and retrieval	Four coding and eight retrieval cases pass in each arm.
Integrated service	Reference outputs, actual route, cancellation and cold recovery	M4 Pro 1K/32K text output checks; all three devices restore 34,464 KV tokens, one state hit and matching output.

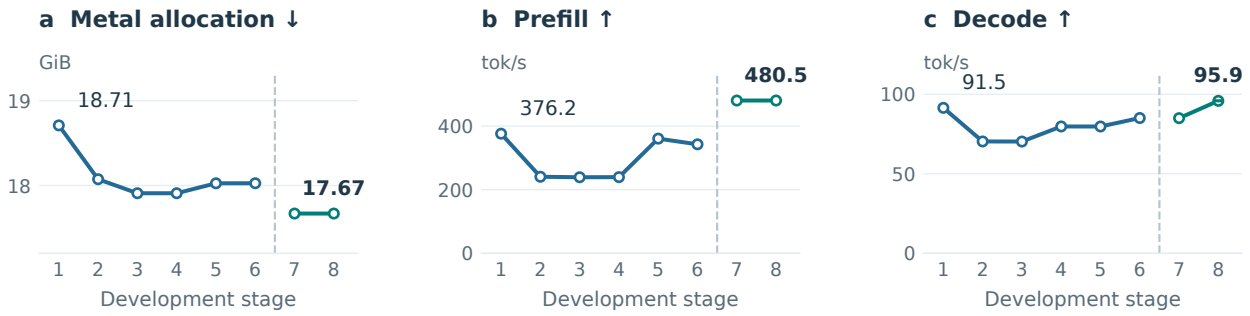


Figure 6. M5 Pro native-GPU development snapshots at fixed 32,768 input and 6,144 output tokens. Stages: (1) INT8 baseline; (2) TQ4; (3) scratch aliasing; (4) rotated verification; (5) staged prefill; (6) verify A8; (7) prefill A8 plus memory updates; (8) coalesced V staging. The dashed boundary separates build cohorts. Earlier stages have one run each; the last shows the median and range of two runs. Metal allocation excludes host and external accelerator memory; its axis starts above zero to resolve the 18.71-to-17.67 GiB change (-5.6%).

6. Discussion and Limitations

Comparison and attribution. Whole-system results combine weight formats, decoders, allocation policies, effective admission budgets and device-specific execution profiles. They establish the behavior of the evaluated configurations, not isolated chip rankings or individual-feature gains. Historical mechanism measurements explain design choices; a final-build factorial ablation of rotated attention, coalesced staging, lookup and adaptive width remains open. The M4 Pro stock comparison lacks a candidate GPU-only timing arm. Counter-derived cycle costs explain its batch plateau descriptively but do not separate verification, drafting, scheduling and hardware causes. No matched KIVI or KVQuant implementation comparison is included.

Workloads and statistics. The headline speed cohort contains eight fixed-output tasks; the natural-EOS matrices contain eight fixtures with three technical repeats and some B4 prefix sharing. Fixture variation, shrinking batch tails and mean-versus-median summaries affect comparisons. Min–max whiskers describe dispersion, and the exploratory eight-fixture bootstrap intervals can under-cover. M4 Pro's small B4-versus-B2 differences and M5 Pro's positive stock-control TG means are descriptive rather than established population improvements. Some early 16K trials overlapped dependency/asset provisioning. The 22,015 MiB speed sanity check covers one prompt per arm; the full speed distribution uses 21,631 MiB. Disk-quota effects on throughput are unmeasured. Two input buckets show an observed trend rather than a context-scaling law.

Capacity and memory scope. The 320K result is warm-prefix aggregate page capacity across two requests with a live draft. Cold admission, single-request 320K and matched long-context answer quality are separate questions. M6's locked 8 GiB reservation approximates available RAM on its physical 32 GiB system; OS, driver and compression behavior can differ from a physical 24 GiB device. M6 speed runs use its full memory configuration. Analytical operand bounds, Metal allocation, process-group footprint and external accelerator memory have different accounting scopes. Historical resource savings cannot be added into a

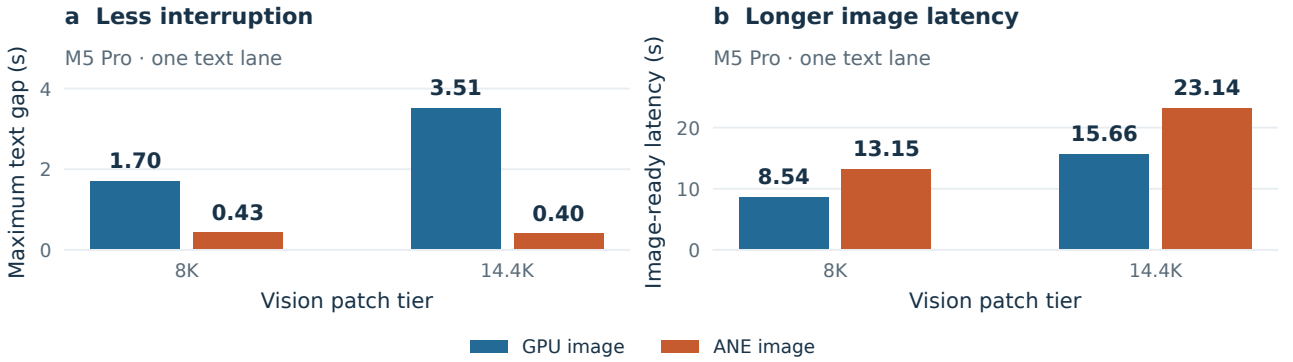


Figure 7. M5 Pro, one incumbent text lane plus one arriving image. Bars are medians of three repeats. All ANE-arm images in these cells execute on ANE. Offload reduces the maximum delivery gap but increases image latency. The no-image maximum gap is approximately 0.107 s.

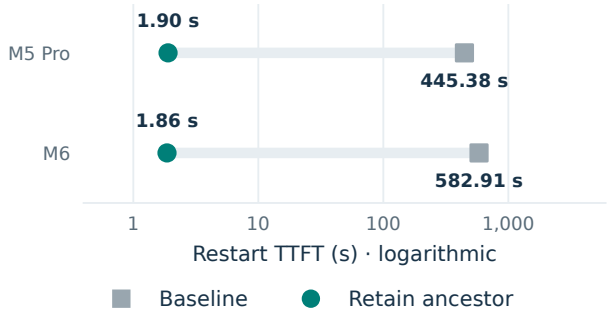


Figure 8. 128K original-history restart after a continuation. Compare the two retention policies within each device; fixture construction differs across devices. Logarithmic TTFT axis. Outputs match within each pair.

single process-peak reduction.

Quality and heterogeneous service. The full-set AIME comparison and selected task subsets provide regression evidence; general quality equivalence and matched vision-quality coverage across all three devices remain unresolved. Embedding error, logit agreement, output equality and semantic correctness measure different properties. Forced ANE diagnostics establish behavior when execution is admitted; final-policy benefit also depends on phase, memory pressure and actual placement. Language-FFN and vision-ANE accuracy require separate controls. Harness preparation and residual image time do not isolate compute from queueing. The M5 Pro single-seed vision gap and the balanced M4 Pro three-seed outcomes retain their separate device and protocol scopes. M4 Pro decode regression and denied ANE attempts remain explicit results.

Persistence and reproducibility. Cold checks restore 34,464 tokens on all three final service configurations, alongside earlier 128K M5 Pro/M6 studies. Repeated final-profile 128K restoration on every device, short-history retention policies, all eviction/branch orders, full-budget saturation and power-loss durability remain open. Request-order tests compare outputs and counters rather than every restored tensor. Filesystem overhead is reconciled for the observed snapshots, without a worst-case or indefinite-operation guarantee. Installation checks qualify artifact functionality at their stated workload sizes; they preserve the identities of the earlier performance evidence.

Implications and future work. The practical benefit is a reusable local inference substrate: a personal assistant can retain task history while sharing compute with speech and vision, and a small business can serve concurrent workflows without moving private context to a hosted model. The next steps are matched final-build ablations, broader long-context and multimodal quality evaluation, and sustained multi-application workloads. These extend the same design goal: preserve useful state and interactive execution within the machine's physical budget.

7. Conclusion

JustFit v2 combines long-context capacity with faster local serving: 256K singleton and 320K aggregate B2 capacity with a resident draft, 9–46% faster prefill than Splash 1.3.0, 2.0–2.5× v1's median decode rate at 16K, and scaling to 157.53 tokens/s with four requests at 1K on M5 Pro. Numerical references, paired reasoning/coding/vision tasks and integrated recovery checks validate the execution changes, with strong retained task scores and the reported A8 and ANE differences. KVExec, PhaseSwap, StateTrans and CrossFire provide the mechanism: keep representations compact at their consumers, bound transient overlap, preserve committed progress and coordinate heterogeneous work. These capabilities let a 24 GiB-class machine retain substantial task history while supporting interactive exe-

cution with evaluated task quality. Assistants, document workflows and multimodal agents can build on this serving layer; the recorded coding-agent case illustrates its use in an extended visual workflow.

Acknowledgments

AI coding and writing assistants (Codex, ChatGPT, Claude) helped with implementation, tests, data organization, editing, LaTeX, and figures. The author is responsible for the code, experiments, and claims.

References

Agrawal, A., Kedia, N., Panwar, A., Mohan, J., Kwatra, N., Gulavani, B. S., Tumanov, A., and Ramjee, R. Taming throughput-latency tradeoff in LLM inference with Sarathi-Serve. In *18th USENIX Symposium on Operating Systems Design and Implementation (OSDI 24)*, 2024. URL https://www.usenix.org/conference/osdi24/presentation/agrawal.

Apple. Deploying transformers on the Apple Neural Engine, 2022. URL https://machinelearning.apple.com/research/neural-engine-transformers.

Ashkboos, S., Mohtashami, A., Croci, M. L., Li, B., Cameron, P., Jaggi, M., Alistarh, D., Hoefler, T., and Hensman, J. QuaRot: Outlier-free 4-bit inference in rotated LLMs. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems*, 2024. URL https://arxiv.org/abs/2404.00456.

Aycock, J. A brief history of just-in-time. *ACM Computing Surveys*, 35(2):97–113, 2003. doi: 10.1145/857076.857077.

Chen, Y. JustFit: Just-in-time state management for local LLM serving, 2026. URL https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.17475v2.

Dao, T., Fu, D. Y., Ermon, S., Rudra, A., and Ré, C. FlashAttention: Fast and memory-efficient exact attention with IO-awareness, 2022. URL https://arxiv.org/abs/2205.14135.

Gao, B., He, Z., Sharma, P., Kang, Q., Jevdjic, D., Deng, J., Yang, X., Yu, Z., and Zuo, P. Cost-efficient large language model serving for multi-turn conversations with CachedAttention. In *2024 USENIX Annual Technical Conference (USENIX ATC 24)*, pp. 111–126, 2024. URL https://www.usenix.org/conference/atc24/presentation/gao-bin-cost.

Hannun, A., Digani, J., Katharopoulos, A., and Collobert, R. MLX: Efficient and flexible machine learning on Apple Silicon, 2023. URL https://github.com/ml-explore/mlx.

He, Z., Zhong, Z., Cai, T., Lee, J., and He, D. REST: Retrieval-based speculative decoding. In *Proceedings of NAACL-HLT*, pp. 1582–1595, 2024. doi: 10.18653/v1/2024.naacl-long.88. URL https://aclanthology.org/2024.naacl-long.88/.

Hooper, C., Kim, S., Mohammadzadeh, H., Mahoney, M. W., Shao, Y. S., Keutzer, K., and Gholami, A. KVQuant: Towards 10 million context length LLM inference with KV cache quantization. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems*, volume 37, 2024. URL https://proceedings.nips.cc/paper_files/paper/2024/hash/028fcbcf85435d39a40c4d61b42c99a4-Abstract-Conference.html.

Inco AI. DFlash 2: Keep drafting parallel, 2026a. URL https://inco.ai/blog/dflash2/.

Inco AI. Splash 1.3.0: A local inference engine for Apple Silicon, 2026b. URL https://github.com/incoai/splash/tree/1.3.0. Evaluated upstream baseline, version 1.3.0.

Inco AI. Splash 1.4.0 release page, 2026c. URL https://github.com/incoai/splash/releases/tag/1.4.0. Released October 20, 2026; subsequent upstream release.

Inco AI. Splash 1.5.0 release page, 2026d. URL https://github.com/incoai/splash/releases/tag/1.5.0. Subsequent upstream release.

Inco AI. Splash: A local engine built around the model, 2026e. URL https://inco.ai/blog/splash/. September 17, 2026 launch report; performance evaluated on a 48 GB M5 Pro.

Inco AI. Qwen3.8-27B-Splash: Model package and hardware requirements, 2026f. URL https://huggingface.co/incoai/Qwen3.8-27B-Splash. Accessed September 30, 2026; documents 36 GB unified memory, 48 GB or more recommended.

Kirisame, M., Lyubomirsky, S., Haan, A., Brennan, J., He, M., Roesch, J., Chen, T., and Tatlock, Z. Dynamic tensor rematerialization. In *International Conference on Learning Representations*, 2021. URL https://arxiv.org/abs/2006.09616.

Kwon, W., Li, Z., Zhuang, S., Sheng, Y., Zheng, L., Yu, C. H., Gonzalez, J. E., Zhang, H., and Stoica, I. Efficient memory management for large language model serving with PagedAttention. In *Proceedings of the 29th*

Symposium on Operating Systems Principles, pp. 611–626, 2023. doi: 10.1145/3600006.3613165. URL https://arxiv.org/abs/2309.06180.

Leviathan, Y., Kalman, M., and Matias, Y. Fast inference from transformers via speculative decoding. In *Proceedings of the 40th International Conference on Machine Learning*, volume 202 of *Proceedings of Machine Learning Research*, 2023. URL https://proceedings.mlr.press/v202/leviathan23a.html.

Liu, Z., Yuan, J., Jin, H., Zhong, S., Xu, Z., Braverman, V., Chen, B., and Hu, X. KIVI: A tuning-free asymmetric 2bit quantization for KV cache. In *Proceedings of the 41st International Conference on Machine Learning*, volume 235, pp. 32332–32344, 2024. URL https://proceedings.mlr.press/v235/liu24bz.html.

NInfer contributors. Qwen3.8-27B: Capability evaluation, 2026a. URL https://github.com/Neroued/ninfer/blob/master/eval/README.md. Independent NVFP4 AIME 2026 evaluation; accessed October 25, 2026.

NInfer contributors. Qwen3.8-27B NVFP4: Reasoning evaluation configuration, 2026b. URL https://github.com/Neroued/ninfer/blob/master/eval/run_qwen3_8_27b_nvfp4_reasoning.sh. INT8 KV configuration; accessed October 25, 2026.

NVIDIA. SPEED-Bench: throughput benchmark dataset. https://huggingface.co/datasets/nvidia/SPEED-Bench, 2026. Pinned throughput_16k/test revision and task identities accompany the experiment record.

Pan, J. and Li, G. A survey of LLM inference systems, 2025. URL https://arxiv.org/abs/2506.21901.

PowerSpy and oMLX contributors. INT8-activation prefill kernels for Qwen3.5/3.6/3.8, 2026. URL https://github.com/jundot/omlx/pull/3548. Pull request 3548.

Prefill Systems. Qwen3.8-27B: Current endpoint measurements, 2026. URL https://prefillsystems.com/benchmarks/qwen3-8-27b. Independent NVFP4 and FP8-KV evaluation; accessed October 25, 2026.

Saxena, A. Prompt lookup decoding, 2023. URL https://github.com/apoorvumang/prompt-lookup-decoding/.

Sheng, Y., Zheng, L., Yuan, B., Li, Z., Ryabinin, M., Fu, D. Y., Xie, Z., Chen, B., Barrett, C., Gonzalez, J. E., Liang, P., Ré, C., Stoica, I., and Zhang, C. FlexGen: High-throughput generative inference of large language models with a single GPU, 2023. URL https://arxiv.org/abs/2303.06865.

syv-ai and HyperQwen contributors. HyperQwen: Lookup-augmented DFlash2 drafting, 2026. URL https://github.com/syv-ai/HyperQwen/blob/main/patches/dflash2-lookup-drafting.patch. Source patch; accessed October 18, 2026.

UkisAI. Swift-Qwen3.8-27B: Base-model and adapter benchmarks, 2026. URL https://huggingface.co/ukisai/Swift-Qwen3.8-27b. Reference uses the unmodified BF16 base-model column; accessed October 25, 2026.

Yang, N., Ge, T., Wang, L., Jiao, B., Jiang, D., Yang, L., Majumder, R., and Wei, F. Inference with reference: Lossless acceleration of large language models, 2023. URL https://arxiv.org/abs/2304.04487.

Yang, S., Kautz, J., and Hatamizadeh, A. Gated delta networks: Improving Mamba2 with delta rule, 2024. URL https://arxiv.org/abs/2412.06464.

Yu, G.-I., Jeong, J. S., Kim, G.-W., Kim, S., and Chun, B.-G. Orca: A distributed serving system for transformer-based generative models. In *16th USENIX Symposium on Operating Systems Design and Implementation (OSDI 22)*, pp. 521–538, 2022. URL https://www.usenix.org/conference/osdi22/presentation/yu.

Zandieh, A., Daliri, M., Hadian, M., and Mirrokni, V. TurboQuant: Online vector quantization with near-optimal distortion rate. In *International Conference on Learning Representations*, 2026. URL https://proceedings.iclr.cc/paper_files/paper/2026/hash/5c802ef38ab6e366c2ea06eee554c088-Abstract-Conference.html.

Zheng, L., Yin, L., Xie, Z., Sun, C., Huang, J., Yu, C. H., Cao, S., Kozyrakis, C., Stoica, I., Gonzalez, J. E., Barrett, C., and Sheng, Y. SGLang: Efficient execution of structured language model programs, 2024. URL https://arxiv.org/abs/2312.07104.

A. Implementation Principles and Derivations

These details support the four mechanisms in the main text. They preserve the codec, ownership and synchronization conditions needed to reproduce the implementation.

A.1. Codec, Page Addressing, and Consumer Contracts

For a nonzero d-dimensional vector x, let $\rho = \|x\|_2$, H_d be an unnormalized Hadamard matrix and S a diagonal random-sign matrix. The normalized rotation and reconstruction are

$$y = Rx/\rho, \qquad R = H_d S/\sqrt{d}, \tag{6}$$

$$z_j = \arg\min_{k\in\{0,\dots,15\}} |y_j - c_k|, \tag{7}$$

$$\widehat{x} = \widehat{\rho} R^{\mathsf{T}} c[z]. \tag{8}$$

The nonuniform scalar centroids and midpoint thresholds are shared. Norm computation uses FP32, its stored value uses FP16, and eight four-bit indices occupy one 32-bit word. K and V use separate random signs. The two-byte norm explains why the effective reduction from FP16 is 3.94×, rather than exactly four. Quantization error comes from the centroid approximation and stored norm; execution error additionally depends on reconstruction and accumulation arithmetic.

Representation parameters are listed in Appendix D. For logical token t in a page of length P, the page-table lookup selects the physical page at $\lfloor t/P \rfloor$, and $t \bmod P$ selects the row. Sharing a prefix shares physical pages through references; allocating a continuation need not duplicate its prefix. The attention consumer must respect logical length and causal masking even when the final physical page is only partially occupied.

Storage and expansion have different scopes. At 256K positions, retained TQ4 across all attention layers occupies 4,160 MiB. Reconstructing all four KV heads for just one layer requires another 1,024 MiB in BF16. Limiting the expanded consumer set to one head bounds this operand to 256 MiB (Figure 9). This bound holds only if preceding consumers complete before their storage is reused; deferred execution can otherwise keep several generations of operands reachable.

A fused reconstruction kernel performs page lookup, nibble unpacking, centroid lookup, inverse rotation and norm restoration into the final consumer operand. This writes the floating consumer operand directly, eliminating intermediate arrays. The MLX predecessor also forces evaluation before progressing to the next head group or layer. In the native path, command dependencies perform the equivalent lifetime enforcement.

For a query block with many rows, staging a head once avoids repeating reconstruction for each query tile. For a short speculative query, that amortization is weaker: rotated-domain attention keeps history in its stored domain and rotates the query instead. Consumer geometry selects the appropriate path. Masks, head mapping, and the state boundary remain identical requirements on either path.

A.2. Lifetime and Ownership Invariants

Let $O_c(t)$ be the owners requiring component c, and let $a_c(t)$ denote whether its evaluated storage is attached. Residency obeys

$$|O_c(t)| > 0 \implies a_c(t) = 1. \tag{9}$$

An owner outlives submission: an asynchronous reader can still require a component after its encoding function returns. A release therefore waits for its last consumer, not merely the end of the host function. Generation-bound owner identifiers prevent an old completion callback from releasing a new cohort's lease.

Host embedding gather illustrates the distinction between placement and lifetime. The native table is mapped read-only on the host and selected rows are gathered into shared input storage. This removes 715,177,984 bytes from the studied Metal fixed allocation, while the mapping still belongs to the same physical memory budget. Gather completion must precede the target consumer. The unconstrained speculative path may require a draft/verify command split because proposal IDs are not known before drafting completes.

The host gather reproduces quantized row reconstruction and BF16 round-to-nearest-even behavior; its archived test compares 777 rows at each of two hidden sizes against the corresponding Metal embedding kernels. A reduced Metal allocation is thus paired with an arithmetic check, rather than inferred from an address-space change.

Workspace aliasing has an equally strict overlap test. A GDN packed input and its output cannot share storage while a gate reads one and writes the other. Later staging buffers can reuse backing only when their earlier consumers finish. Decode-owned RoPE constants must remain available even after prefill-only arenas are released. These ownership constraints determine the safe aliasing graph.

Appendix D collects the separately measured resource effects. The predecessor's untied output head is a different object from the native token embedding: its 644.14 MiB can be detached during eligible intermediate prefill, but must return for logits. An incumbent decoder keeps its head lease while another request prefills. Conflating these components would incorrectly count the same phase-local saving as permanent capacity.

An elastic arena helps capacity when its lifetime overlaps the limiting peak. In its initial cold two-lane experiment,

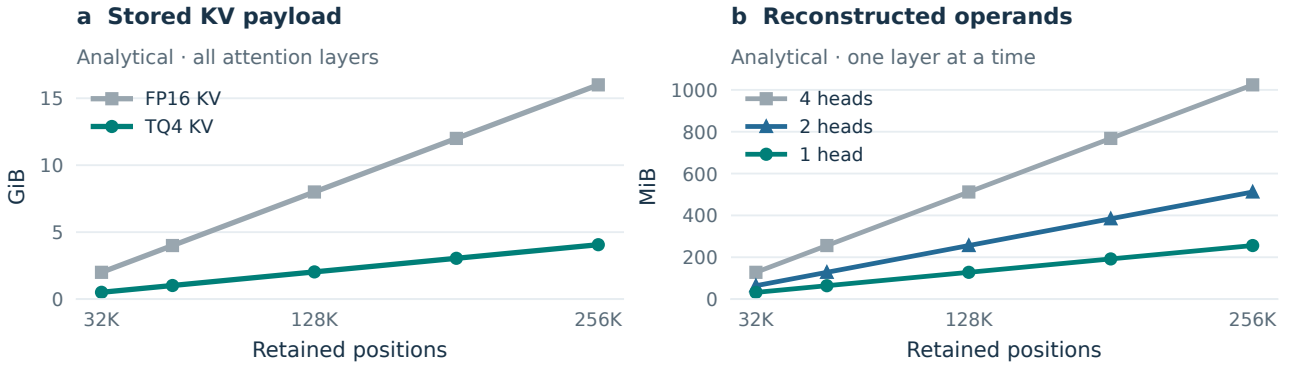


Figure 9. Analytical payload bounds. Left: attention KV across all 16 layers. Right: temporary BF16 K/V operands for one attention layer with four KV heads, two-head grouping, or one-head staging. Weights, recurrent state, allocator overhead and other workspaces are excluded.

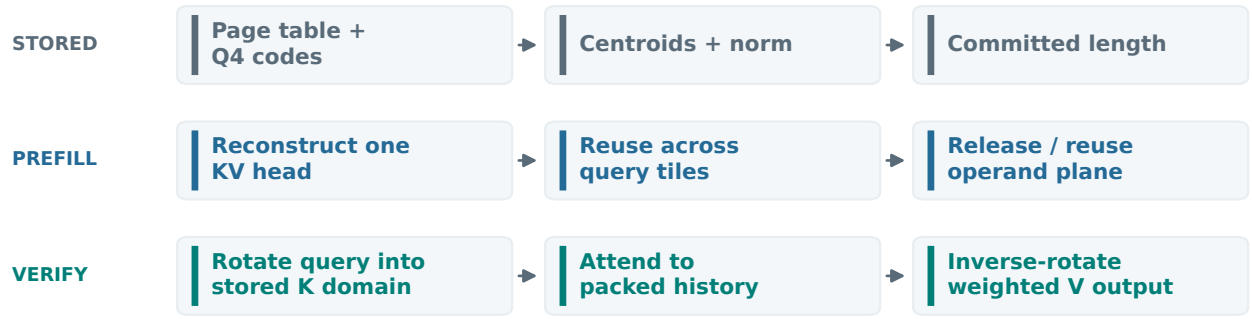


Figure 10. Three consumers of the same packed history. The prefill path amortizes one head reconstruction across query tiles; short verification instead moves the query/output transforms around attention. Boxes show data and operations.

the second request still needed prefill storage at the limiting instant, and the binding constraint moved to host memory. Its mixed-arrival run reduced Metal peak by about 130 MiB but did not improve that cold capacity boundary. This illustrates why the live-set maximum must be evaluated over the entire workload.

A.3. Lookup and Adaptive Useful Work

A speculation cycle contains proposal construction, target verification, acceptance, and state reconciliation. Let a_r be committed tokens and τ_r the complete cycle time at verification width r. The useful rate is a_r/τ_r; a longer proposal is beneficial only if its accepted work offsets its draft, verify and replay cost. The row constraint is $\sum_i r_i \leq 32$; the evaluated homogeneous implementation specializes this to $br \leq 32$.

Widening helps only when accepted work grows faster than cycle cost:

$$a_{16}/a_8 > \tau_{16}/\tau_8. \tag{10}$$

The context-lookup extension follows HyperQwen (syv-ai and HyperQwen contributors, 2026), retaining DFlash2's seven learned proposal tokens. A context-derived continuation supplies an extended proposal only if its first seven tokens agree with that learned head. On disagreement, the learned head remains and the lookup tail is invalidated. This prevents a repeated field name from replacing a correct learned value with a stale continuation. Target verification, rather than context lookup, decides which tokens become committed output.

The archived controller observes signals from the preceding completed step: whether the lookup tail can be filled and whether at least eight tokens were emitted. Two consecutive favorable observations allow wider verification when the row budget permits it. Singleton execution retains that preference for up to three further steps; multi-lane execution does not use that sticky interval. The controller uses these recent observations to adapt to available proposal work.

Acceptance and rollback align target KV, recurrent state, draft context, masks and logical offsets. Actual width is recorded during common-active intervals: B4 uses eight rows, while a subsequent B2 tail can widen to sixteen.

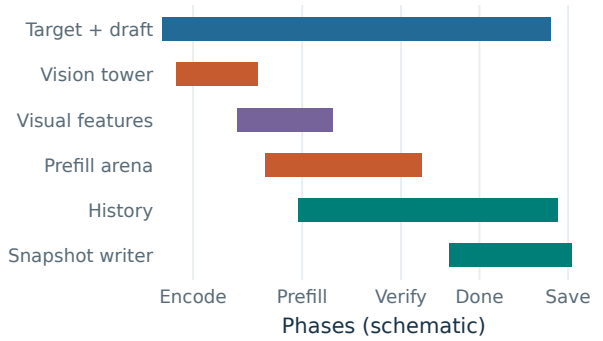


Figure 11. Conceptual resource lifetimes for an image-bearing request. Target/draft residency spans generation; vision and prefill storage end at their last consumers. A composite snapshot can outlive request completion through its own writer ownership. The native draft stays resident; the predecessor's concurrent-AR policy released its singleton predictor. Intervals are schematic.

Table 6. Adaptive verification decision at a completed-step boundary. This describes the studied controller; it does not change target acceptance or sampling semantics.

Condition	Action
Row budget cannot fit width 16	Keep width 8
Two favorable prior observations	Select 16; singleton sticky count 3
Singleton sticky count remains	Select 16; decrement count
Otherwise	Select 8
Lookup head disagrees	Keep learned head; invalidate tail
Target rejects a suffix	Commit accepted boundary; reconcile state

A.4. Transitions, Publication, and Recovery Ordering

The native cache uses upstream composite snapshots and transfer machinery. This section states the continuity invariants used by JustFit; the native persistence extension is the ancestor-retention policy evaluated below. The reusable boundary is a tuple

$$C_t = (K_t, S_t^{\text{recurrent}}, D_t, \ell_t, I_t), \tag{11}$$

where K_t denotes target KV, D_t the draft context, ℓ_t logical offsets and I_t relevant input identities. Every element must describe the same committed prefix. Tokens proposed but not accepted do not advance that prefix. For multimodal inputs, matching text IDs alone is insufficient: overlapping segments must also carry the image identity.

Queue arrival alone does not consume an execution lane or change an incumbent's state. The MLX predecessor reserves an unshared request's prompt plus up to 8,192 output tokens in 256-token-page equivalents; shared prefixes require reference-aware accounting. That particular reserve policy is distinct from unlimited output completion. Native admission additionally accounts for its resident draft and selected verification workspace.

Table 7. Serving-transition ordering. These invariants apply across both execution modes; v2 retains its draft where v1 could switch to concurrent AR.

Step	Required action
1	Finish the current speculative round and its outstanding consumers.
2	Commit accepted progress; reconcile rejected tentative state.
3	Filter completed/cancelled requests; decrement page references.
4	Check page, output-reserve, phase and workspace admission.
5	Admit the new request; bind owners to the new cohort generation.
6	Interleave prefill slices with incumbent decode.
7	Publish only a consistent committed composite state.

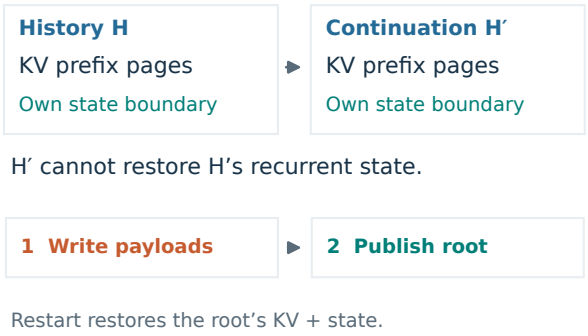


Figure 12. Composite continuation and ancestor retention. H and its continuation H′ share KV prefix pages but require their own recurrent-state boundary. A durable H′ does not reconstruct H's recurrent state. Publication exposes the root only after its required payloads. Arrows show publication dependencies.

Checkpoint ownership is independent of request completion. The synchronous borrowed writer may retain page-run views because the producer cannot mutate them before serialization returns. An asynchronous writer must hold stable page/state references. Segment payload and state data become durable before a root is published; otherwise a visible root could reference incomplete data. On transfer failure, an optional save may be abandoned while generation and its source state remain valid.

Demand-allocated persistence staging. A later native revision removes a permanently reserved 196,083,712-byte (187 MiB) staging buffer. An asynchronous transfer instead retains an immutable owning source until IO completion. When snapshot-memory admission fails, a synchronous

direct-to-disk path borrows the live lane state and waits for serialization before that state may change. Thus memory denial need not silently discard the recovery point, and cancellation cannot free a still-consumed source. Small and full-187 MiB native IO checks exercise this ownership and fallback; model-level cold/restart checks on each device reproduce 64 output tokens exactly with one composite-state hit and 8,704 disk KV tokens. Transfers retain their own memory and IO costs while eliminating the permanent reservation. The warm B2 capacity experiment in Section 5.1 uses this revision; the earlier cold-admission and persistence studies retain their original identities.

Background saves can themselves prevent recovery by pinning pages needed for admission. A historical pressure test first restored an agent state, then immediately evicted it because pending saves pinned the pressure request's pages. The revised policy releases references as segments finish and allows pending work to yield under pressure. In the controlled follow-up, the next turn and a fork each restore 16,640 tokens and recompute 633, with disk-restore times 298 and 256 ms. Injected segment-write failures instead cause recomputation; all four requests complete, with no leftover root or temporary file. These tests concern ownership and failure ordering, distinct from the ancestor-retention defect in Section 5.7.

A.5. Layer Slices Preserve Matrix Efficiency

Shrinking a token chunk improves scheduling opportunities but can underutilize matrix hardware. Layered prefill retains a large chunk and executes consecutive layer ranges as separately schedulable parts. Hidden state, destination reservations and recurrent parity remain live between parts. The public chunk offset advances only when all required layers reach a consistent boundary. A final short prompt should not be attached to a long multi-part chunk if doing so would postpone its first logits until the long chunk completes.

The chunk target and slice target control different tradeoffs. The former changes arithmetic geometry and new-arrival wait; the latter changes opportunities to serve incumbent decode. Neither is a hard latency bound. The measured 32K setting uses a 2,000 ms chunk target and 500 ms slice target. At 128K, matching the incumbent's decode share is necessary before attributing prefill improvements: a setting that gives decode more service can make the incoming prompt slower even while total service improves.

A.6. Two Execution Forms and Their Synchronization

For $Y = XW$, the projection can partition output columns as $Y = [XW_{\mathrm{GPU}}, XW_{\mathrm{CPU}}]$. Both producers must complete before a consumer uses all of Y. The CPU fraction and thread count affect load balance; assigning more columns to CPU need not improve wall time. Synchronization must also avoid submitting a GPU wait that can time out before its CPU producer becomes runnable. Producer completion, host-job readiness and suffix submission are separate events that require traceable ordering.

The CPU numerical path must match the intended reconstruction arithmetic. Rounding dequantized weights to BF16 before an otherwise FP32 product can introduce a systematic difference. The studied CPU-SME work uses a GPU-matched reconstruction path and operator comparisons on the same inputs. W4A8 is a separate choice: selective INT8 activation arithmetic on supported GPUs may increase throughput while changing logits and acceptance. Prefill A8 and verify A8 therefore have independent controls.

The ANE path partitions work across requests rather than projection columns. An image must fit a supported capacity tier, its compiled graph must have verified placement, and worker plus payload memory must be admitted. GPU text work can overlap the tower, but the resulting visual embedding and image-language prefill still consume GPU resources. Phase and contention determine the scheduling benefit.

A.7. Vision Graph Geometry and Numerical Conditioning

The full tower comprises 27 layers executed in nine three-layer groups. Fixed-capacity assets accept runtime positions and masks; four raw image patches merge into one language-side visual token. Capacity therefore must not be confused with language context length. Padding an image into a larger tier still executes dense work in the studied graph.

For 16 attention heads and query tiles of 1,024 rows, a three-layer group contains

$$N_{\mathrm{tiles}} = 3 \times 16 \times \lceil C/1024 \rceil. \tag{12}$$

Capacities 4,096, 8,192 and 14,400 yield 192, 384 and 720 tiles. Dense attention pair work grows quadratically in capacity, while projections grow linearly. This explains why tier selection matters even when masked padding is semantically inert. Compiler time is measured separately from this operation count.

Low-precision errors require operator-level references. LayerNorm range conditioning addresses variance overflow while preserving the intended normalization; original GELU operand ordering avoids an unintended approximation change. Rescaling probability–value multiplication,

$$PV = ((sP)V)/s, \tag{13}$$

can move intermediates into a better representable range without changing real-arithmetic semantics. In a sampled historical correction with $s = 64$, relative error falls from 21.283% to 0.213%; splitting reduction alone leaves

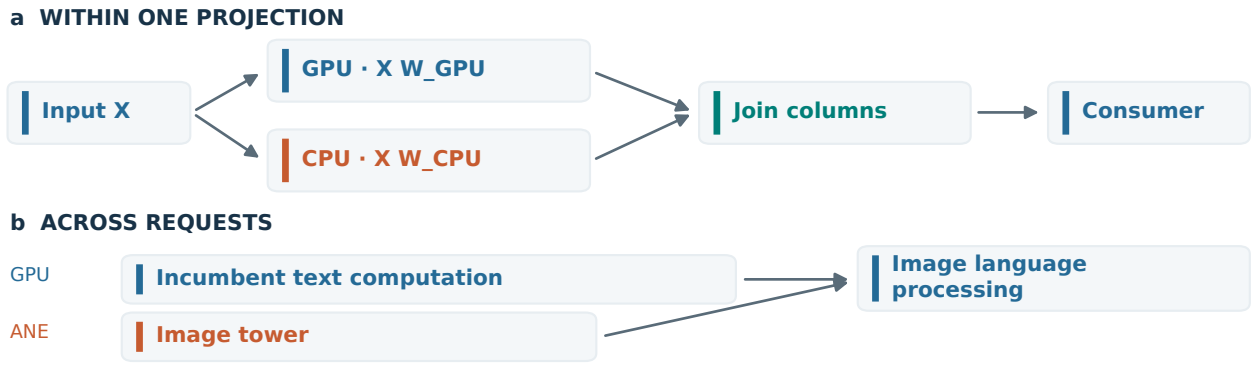


Figure 13. CrossFire's distinct forms. Top: CPU and GPU compute disjoint output-column partitions of a projection and join before its consumer. Bottom: ANE image encoding overlaps GPU text work; image-language processing still returns to GPU. Intervals are schematic.

Table 8. Historical M5 Pro full-ANE tower observations. Each tier uses a different recorded image; these rows are not a same-image scaling experiment.

Tier capacity	Encoder core (s)	FP32-relative L2 (%)
4,096	0.903	0.683
8,192	5.606	3.190
14,400	14.747	2.987

21.280%. This local result is separate from the aligned full-tower recipe and from answer accuracy.

Worker lifecycle is part of the interface: input ownership lasts through encoding, reservations are released on completion or cancellation, and unsupported shapes or denied admission take an explicit GPU route. A measured worker lease is not total accelerator memory; external service storage and shared pages can complicate physical attribution. The HTTP and concurrency studies therefore record actual encoding and reservation outcomes in addition to core timing.

B. Supplemental Evaluation and Protocols

Batch-matrix storage settings. The native 1K/32K batch matrices use configurable persistent disk-cache quotas of 128 GiB on M4 Pro and 2 GiB on M5 Pro/M6. These are storage-retention settings; their effect on throughput was not isolated.

B.1. Full-set AIME Execution Protocol

The evaluation uses the EvalScope AIME prompt, a 98,304-token output cap, temperature 1.0, top-p 0.95, top-k 20, `xhigh` reasoning effort, and seeds 20260811, 20260812 and 20260813. Each seed covers all 30 questions in two 15-question halves. The even-index half at the first two seeds runs one question per engine; the other four half-set runs use two concurrent questions per engine (B2), with a final singleton. Within each half-set, the A8-off/on arms share prompts, sampling and concurrency; arm order alternates by question or batch. The reported score pools 90 attempts per arm across these matched runs.

Paired speed comparisons. Table 9 reports the paired dispersion over eight fixtures, each with three technical repeats. Both M5 Pro fixture-bootstrap intervals cross zero, so the positive mean TG differences remain tentative across workloads. M4 Pro's 32K prefill improves by 7.61%, while decode falls by 9.45%, exceeding the experiment's descriptive 7.5% slowdown criterion. The candidate GPU-only timing arm needed to isolate its CPU-partition contribution is absent. A separate M6 language-ANE toggle raises 32K visible PP from 360.72 to 399.74 and reduces TG from 36.34 to 34.66.

Useful work per cycle. Table 10 instantiates the useful-work/cycle-cost framework using counter differences within each cohort. For cohort i, let D_i be drafted tokens, A_i accepted draft tokens, O_i decode output tokens, N_i decode batches, and T_i accumulated decode-cycle milliseconds. We compute A_i/D_i, O_i/N_i, and T_i/N_i, then average each ratio across the 24 cohorts. Output tokens are measured directly, not reconstructed from accepted drafts. The peak column is the maximum observed owned-group footprint.

For M5 Pro 32K, mean output per batch grows from 4.95 to 16.13 (3.26×), while mean cycle time grows from 87.0 to 146.7 ms (1.69×). For M4 Pro 32K, output per batch grows from 4.53 to 15.78 (3.48×), but cycle time grows from 110.8 to 367.9 ms (3.32×), while draft acceptance changes only from 0.504 to 0.497. M4 Pro cycle time is 1.27× M5 Pro at B1 and 2.51× at B4. Thus increasing cycle cost nearly offsets the increased useful output on M4 Pro; the aggregate counters narrow the observed plateau to width-dependent cycle cost, rather than a large collapse in acceptance. These

Table 9. Client TG dispersion and task+repeat pairing. Parentheses are sample SD; paired change is the mean of per-pair percentages, unlike the ratio of means in Table 3. Intervals are exploratory percentile bootstrap intervals resampling eight fixtures with all three repeats retained (20,000 draws). Positive counts are over eight fixture means. With only eight selected fixtures, percentile intervals can under-cover and do not establish population significance. For M4 Pro 32K, a fixture-level t sensitivity check gives $t = -2.27$ (7 df), $p \approx 0.058$; its 95% t interval includes zero.

Device	Input	Stock TG (SD)	Candidate TG (SD)	Paired % (SD)	Positive fixtures	Fixture 95% interval
M4 Pro	1K	56.43 (6.07)	57.22 (4.81)	+2.09 (10.26)	4/8	-3.77, +9.76
M4 Pro	32K	45.20 (5.70)	40.93 (4.04)	-8.61 (10.27)	1/8	-15.11, -1.30
M5 Pro	1K	65.54 (6.33)	70.92 (7.84)	+9.00 (13.65)	6/8	-1.31, +16.93
M5 Pro	32K	55.02 (7.35)	56.90 (9.70)	+3.53 (11.78)	5/8	-4.63, +11.37

counters cover complete cycles, including full occupancy and shrinking tails; Table 2 defines their aggregation.

Common-active TG counts callback-delivered tokens in the interval from the latest first-token event to the earliest final-token event. Its difference from native aggregate TG includes timing conventions and the cohort tail. B4/B1 ratios paired by fixture anchor and repeat are supplied in the data supplement, but B4 also adds other fixtures, so these are not equal-work matched requests.

At M5 Pro 1K, maximum request-phase footprint is 18.40 GiB for stock and 17.18 GiB for the candidate; at 32K it is 19.46 versus 17.52 GiB. These observations include different KV representations and allocation policies. They quantify the memory reduction of the complete configuration.

B.2. Capacity and Retained Progress

MLX-VLM service-capacity protocol. The 30K point uses the historical MXFP4/TQ4/MTP configuration on M4 Pro: 14,336 input tokens including one original 1080p image, followed by 16,384 forced output tokens, with APC and disk persistence enabled. The cold request completes in 1,187.25 s with a 20.82 GiB owned-process-group peak and writes 2.04 GiB of cache without triggering the 22,015 MiB physical-memory guard. This is a completed service workload, not a searched maximum; a separate text-only test with APC disabled completes 65,472 input plus 64 output tokens. The headline distinguishes the image/APC workload from the warm text-capacity tests of JustFit; it does not report a matched-workload capacity ratio.

M4 Pro completes 128K singleton and total-300K B2 checks, a bounded two-hour/12-cycle run, and three-repeat B2/B3/B4 retention tests. These earlier experiments establish retained progress under their recorded configurations.

An M5 Pro two-lane workload retains 131,072 input plus 16,384 output tokens per lane, with peak owned-group footprint of 20.97 GiB. Both lanes terminate at the forced 16,384-token output limit, with context lookup and prefill/verify A8 enabled. Under this forced-output protocol, aggregate common-active decode reaches 118.56 tokens/s. This rate characterizes the long-output capacity workload; the shorter-output batch matrix uses a different generation protocol and is reported separately. One decode-state publication fails, separating successful generation from subsequent history reuse. A separate singleton retrieves the expected checkpoints from 261,632 prompt tokens and emits 36 tokens without recorded replay. The later warm-prefix checks in Section 5.1 extend B2 capacity to all three configurations with their own budgets and output shapes.

B.3. Task Validation and Integrated Checks

The paired task outcomes are presented in Section 5.3. The numerical-reference study below and integrated checks in Appendix B.9 complete that evidence chain; additional M4 Pro vision routing coverage is reported separately in Table 14.

The M5 Pro three-tier vision profile encodes 27 questions through 4K and two through 8K with full-ANE/no-GPU placement. One remaining question exceeds 14.4K capacity and falls back to GPU. Thus this packet contains no 14.4K task-quality sample. The paired actual-ANE subset scores GPU 26/29 versus ANE 24/29 (Figure 15); the GPU control is reused after input/build/settings identity checks. The paired breakdown is 24 questions correct in both arms, three incorrect in both, and two—Music_134 and Pharmacy_333—correct only in the GPU arm. The observed gap is 6.9 percentage points in this 29-question cohort. Repeated-seed confirmation on M5 Pro and numerical diagnosis of those two cases remain open; this experiment does not establish a general ANE accuracy-loss rate. Additional M4 Pro outcomes follow below under their own protocol; Section 6 discusses statistical scope.

B.4. Restore Boundaries and Supplemental Validation

The threshold is defined on stored chain length, not nominal prompt length: on M5 Pro, a 32,768-token prompt stores 32,736 tokens and remains below threshold; a 32,800-token prompt stores 32,768 and benefits. Shorter ancestor histories are not universally preserved. In the M6 16,025-token

Table 10. Counter-derived cycle measurements, 24 cohorts per cell. Native and common-active TG use different clock/window definitions. Rate, acceptance, output/batch and ms/batch columns are means of 24 cohort ratios; peak is the maximum footprint across those cohorts, not total machine or ANE service memory.

Device	Input	B	Native TG	Common-active TG	A/D	Tokens/batch	ms/batch	Peak GiB
M4 Pro	1K	1	58.03	57.85	0.610	5.27	91.1	17.67
M4 Pro	1K	2	61.10	60.97	0.604	9.36	153.2	17.67
M4 Pro	1K	4	60.35	59.02	0.579	16.82	279.8	18.52
M4 Pro	32K	1	40.92	40.83	0.504	4.53	110.8	17.24
M4 Pro	32K	2	43.32	43.08	0.501	8.59	199.0	18.28
M4 Pro	32K	4	43.12	42.75	0.497	15.78	367.9	19.71
M5 Pro	1K	1	70.52	70.41	0.554	5.32	75.5	17.16
M5 Pro	1K	2	107.31	117.46	0.538	9.01	84.1	17.16
M5 Pro	1K	4	157.53	166.77	0.573	17.18	109.6	18.40
M5 Pro	32K	1	56.84	56.70	0.506	4.95	87.0	17.16
M5 Pro	32K	2	83.84	87.16	0.501	8.81	105.2	18.13
M5 Pro	32K	4	111.28	116.21	0.522	16.13	146.7	19.95
M6	1K	1	42.29	42.17	0.535	5.11	121.1	17.80
M6	1K	2	69.17	76.03	0.516	8.91	128.8	17.82
M6	1K	4	110.79	119.94	0.558	17.04	154.4	18.80
M6	32K	1	34.58	34.50	0.497	4.71	136.3	17.80
M6	32K	2	56.60	58.89	0.503	8.78	155.5	18.78
M6	32K	4	81.30	86.02	0.524	16.38	201.9	20.87

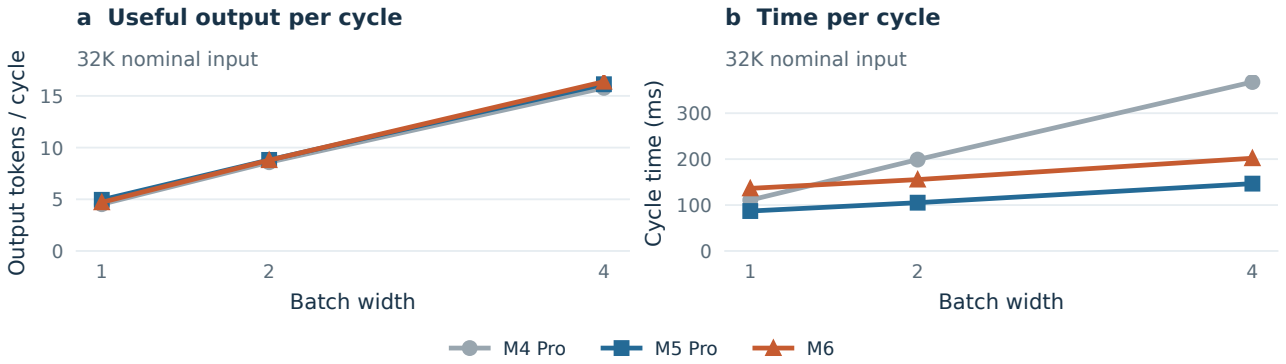


Figure 14. Measured useful work and cycle cost at nominal 32K input. Each point is the mean of 24 per-cohort counter ratios. Both useful output and cost increase with concurrency; these measurements include shrinking tails and are not isolated verification-kernel timings.

fixture, both policies retain the ordinary state at 16,000 tokens; this common hit does not demonstrate deep-ancestor retention. The M5 Pro 16,384-token fixture instead loses the ancestor state after continuation, so both policies recompute below the retention threshold. In a fresh-process H′-first control, all ten combinations of five lengths and two retention policies show the expected disk-KV reuse, a recurrent-state hit, and matching outputs. This isolates continuation persistence from ancestor retention and from pages warmed by an earlier request.

A small-quota experiment bounds reported KV disk use at 3,221,143,552 bytes under a 3 GiB setting, but all six requested histories recompute in its oldest-first restart sequence. Outputs remain equal. The counter excludes some state/metadata storage. The next experiment follows a surviving chain through eviction and reconciles budget accounting with filesystem occupancy.

Integrated-build restart and request order. A separate M5 Pro experiment tests ancestor retention in the integrated serving implementation. It uses a 128 GiB persistent-cache budget and two independent writer/restart groups with H of 131,072 tokens and H′ of 131,104 tokens. The first group requests H first after restart; the second requests H′ first. Table 11 reports only the first request in each new process. Both restore the expected disk KV and recurrent state, recompute 32 tokens, and reproduce the writer's output token sequence. Each ordering has one deterministic functional observation.

The second request in each process obtains zero additional

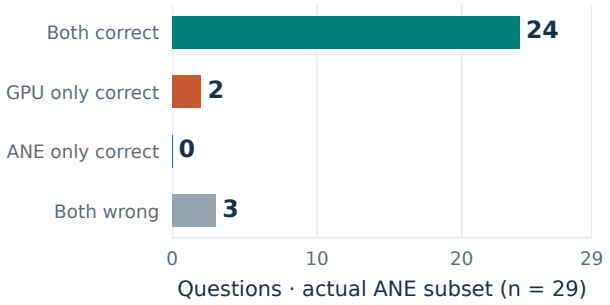


Figure 15. Paired outcomes on the 29 questions actually encoded by ANE. Two discordances favor GPU at the evaluated seed. The selected sample contains 29 paired questions.

Table 11. M5 Pro integrated-build cold recovery. Only the first request after a fresh-process restart is counted. Both outputs exactly match their respective writer references.

First	Disk KV	State hits	Recompute	TTFT (s)
H	131,040	1	32	1.732
H′	131,072	1	32	1.731

disk-KV hits because its pages are already resident. Its TTFT is 1.092 seconds (H′ after H) or 1.083 seconds (H after H′), with matching output. Figure 16 therefore separates cold recovery from same-process reuse. These tests check output trajectories and restore counters on M5 Pro with language ANE disabled.

Real eviction and storage accounting. A separate 1 GiB control writes three independent 32,800-token histories. A restores 32,768 disk tokens before pressure. After B and C are written, A has been evicted and recomputes all 32,800 tokens, whereas C restores 32,768 disk tokens and recomputes 32. All three checked outputs match their cold references (Table 12). The first seeded history occupies 715 MiB of budget-accounted storage (528 MiB of allocated KV storage covering prompt and generated tokens, plus 187 MiB state), so two such resident disk copies cannot fit within 1 GiB. B is not requested after the final write, and no claim is made about its recoverability. Thus correct eviction can coexist with correct restoration of a surviving chain; eviction is not itself a restore defect.

Budget-accounted storage and physical SSD allocation differ because of sparse files, slot-allocation slack and metadata. In the 1 GiB control, physical allocation exceeds the configured quota by about 6.76 MiB. The quota bounds accounted cache storage rather than total filesystem occupancy; Appendix J gives the byte-level reconciliation.

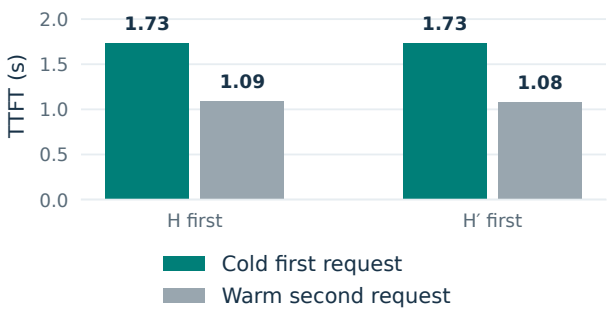


Figure 16. Request-order control on M5 Pro. One observation per bar. Cold restart and subsequent in-process reuse are different operations; the latter is not an additional cold-recovery sample.

Table 12. M5 Pro small-budget eviction control. Each row is one observed request; state hits are one for the restored rows and zero for evicted A.

Request	Disk KV	Recompute	Exact
A before pressure	32,768	32	yes
A after pressure	0	32,800	yes
C after pressure	32,768	32	yes

B.5. Mechanism Measurements and Tradeoffs

The following earlier native and MLX experiments explain the execution and scheduling choices behind the design.

Rotated-domain verification reduces the M5 Pro cycle from 100.2/100.3 to 93.4/93.5 ms at 16K, and from 145.0/145.2 to 120.9/120.9 ms at 64K. The corresponding split-attention kernel changes from 18.0 to 10.9 ms and from 62.6 to 38.3 ms. End-to-end generation also changes its trajectory: at 16K, an explanation task improves from 28.7 to 30.2 tokens/s, while a copy task falls from 35.7 to 35.0. At 32K the two tasks change from 28.2 to 30.8 and 34.7 to 42.5; at 64K from 21.8 to 25.7 and 42.0 to 47.3. This variation motivates measuring both cycle cost and accepted work.

Coalesced V staging changes the address mapping rather than the codebook. In its historical M5 Pro 32K+6K workload, TG rises from 85.01 to 95.88 tokens/s, with a 95.91 repeat. The recorded outputs and acceptance are unchanged in that comparison. This layout experiment holds the codebook and recorded outputs fixed.

At 32K, layering improves incoming prefill by 13.0% and incumbent decode by 68.7%, with byte-identical outputs in all repeated runs. At 128K, the 2000/500 setting reallocates service toward decode and slightly slows the incoming prefill. The 4000/1500 setting approximately matches the control's incumbent TG and improves prefill. The policy selects a service tradeoff; a throughput-only summary would hide it.

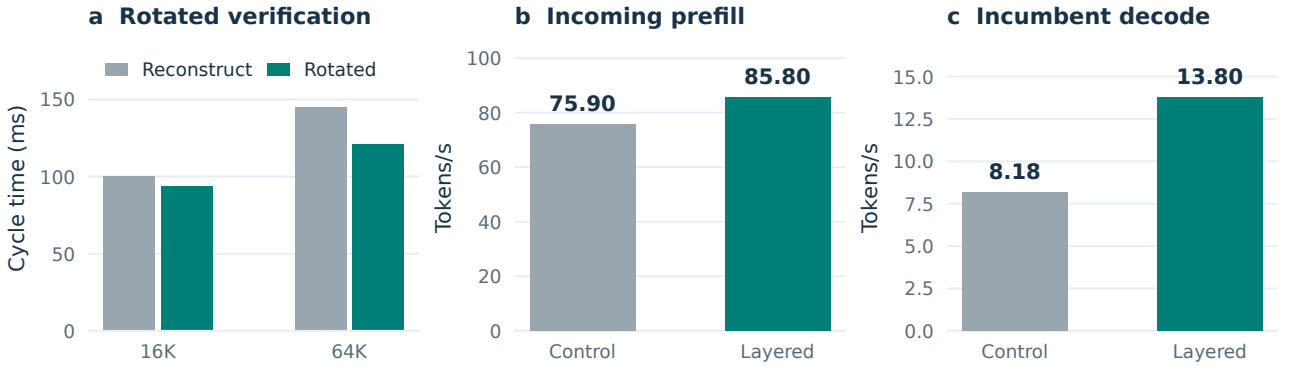


Figure 17. Historical mechanism measurements. Left: M5 Pro real-model verification cycles, two observations per arm at each length. Middle/right: M4 Pro 32K mixed-arrival medians, four control and three layered-prefill runs. Layering improves prefill and incumbent decode, but chat TTFT rises from 1.58 to 1.91 s. These are separate configurations and workloads.

Table 13. Layered-prefill tradeoffs on M4 Pro. The 32K rows are repeated medians; the 128K settings have one observation each. For the 128K layered settings the incumbent output budget is extended to span the full prefill. This prevents an artificially uncontended tail.

Incoming input	Policy	PP (tok/s)	Incumbent TG	Gap p99 (s)	Prefill wall (s)	Chat TTFT (s)
32K	Token-chunk control	75.9	8.18	1.984	431.8	1.58
32K	Layered 2000/500 ms	85.8	13.80	1.107	381.8	1.91
128K	Token-chunk control	42.9	5.2	3.99	3057.0	1.85–4.00
128K	Layered 2000/500 ms	41.5	14.1	1.11	3156.5	2.00–3.05
128K	Layered 4000/1500 ms	63.7	5.3	2.82	2056.5	3.10–4.37

Verification workspace and width. In the cooled M5 Pro study, the wider alternative has shared workspace 425.055 MiB rather than 220.098 MiB. At 4K input its TG improves by 3.815% for B3 and 2.387% for B4; at 32K the changes are +0.798% and -0.321%. All eight paired outputs match. Process-peak differences are recorded separately from this shared-allocation delta.

The separate non-A8 comparison reduces shared workspace from 421.234 to 219.500 MiB, holding its activation setting fixed.

B.6. Numerical Validation: Three Reference Levels

An independent codec reference checks unpacking, centroids, rotations and norms separately from target attention. A higher-precision attention reference on fixed inputs then separates compression distortion from additional kernel arithmetic error. Finally, full-model comparisons track accepted tokens, output length and graded tasks. Agreement at one level does not imply agreement at another.

In the archived first-chunk TQ4 study, sampled vector reconstruction distortion is approximately 9.425–9.785%. A separate population-quadrature Lloyd–Max calculation with 16 scalar levels gives relative RMS of 9.747% for a standard Gaussian and 9.699% for a coordinate of a uniform 256-dimensional sphere, scaled to unit variance. Three initializations converge to the same values. Their proximity to the sampled reconstruction error provides a distribution-level consistency check under those scalar models. Across six captured sets at final query row 2,047, attention-output intrinsic relative RMS is 4.34–8.53%, while additional native arithmetic error is 0.165–0.175%. The study samples two prompts, three layers and all four KV heads. A fixed-history replay avoids confusing accumulated trajectory differences with a local operator defect.

Task scoring distinguishes completed incorrect answers from output-capped or ungraded attempts. Table 4 retains these counts alongside correct answers so that an execution limit is visible separately from a completed reasoning error.

B.7. Additional M4 Pro vision and interference evidence

A separate M4 Pro packet completes 36 image-pipeline requests, 90 quality requests, and 18 image-arrival cohorts without execution failure. Task accuracy is reported separately. The quality packet comprises 30 GPU controls, 30 original diagnostic requests, and 30 additional 8K-coverage requests; the latter reuse the same questions and are not 30 new independent samples. Table 14 separates these protocols. The coverage supplement increases actual ANE execution from two questions to 29; the protocols remain separate in the table.

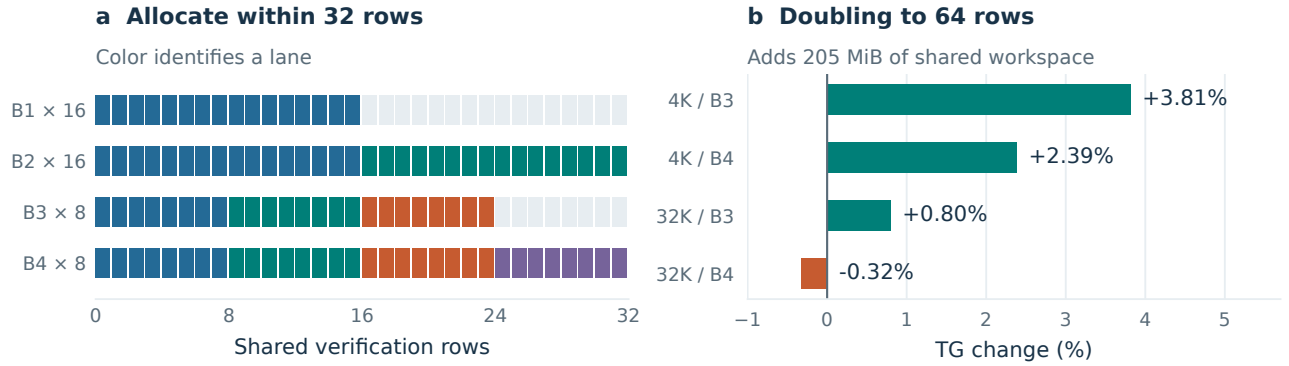


Figure 18. Left: conceptual packing of a shared 32-row verification workspace. B3 uses eight rows per lane and leaves eight unused; B4 uses all 32. Right: historical cooled M5 Pro comparisons of 64 versus 32 shared rows with prefill and target FFN A8 enabled. Wider rows add 204.957 MiB of shared storage; the 32K throughput differences are small.

Table 14. M4 Pro quality counts separated by diagnostic protocol. Actual ANE denotes at least one encoded image; aggregate requested-arm accuracy includes fallback. The coverage supplement changes routing coverage and is not pooled with the original diagnostic.

Arm	Requests	Correct	Actual ANE
gpu	30	25	0
ane-diagnostic	30	25	2
8K coverage	30	24	29

Three-seed GPU/ANE vision comparison. A subsequent M4 Pro test evaluates the same frozen 30-question MMMU-Pro selection at seeds 20260811, 20260812 and 20260813, with one fresh process per question and arm. It uses a 98,304-token output cap, temperature 1.0, top-p 0.95, top-k 20, `xhigh` reasoning effort and natural stopping. All 180 generations finish naturally. The qualified 4K/8K vision profiles encode 29 questions on ANE at every seed with full-ANE/no-GPU placement; the remaining question has 16,060 image patches and follows the GPU-only route in both arms, so its three pairs are excluded from the accelerator comparison. Pixel-buffer hashes and image-span metadata match within all 90 input pairs.

Across the 87 actual-ANE pairs, GPU and ANE each answer **75/87 correctly (86.2%)**. Per-seed counts are 25 versus 24, 26 versus 25, and 24 versus 26 (GPU versus ANE). Both arms are correct on 71 attempts and incorrect on eight; four discordances favor GPU and four favor ANE. The repeated test therefore shows no aggregate ANE vision deficit in this selected cohort, while individual answers can change. These are three repeated attempts on each of 29 questions, rather than 87 independent questions. This test measures task quality; its timings are excluded from the performance comparisons.

Figure 19 and Table 15 show that, for one text lane, the maximum-gap median falls from 3.315 s (GPU image) to 0.474 s (ANE image), while image-ready latency increases from 32.97 to 36.91 s. With three text lanes, corresponding gaps are 0.542 and 0.364 s and image-ready latencies are 83.28 and 80.61 s. The modest three-lane image-latency advantage is consistent with offloading tower work reducing GPU contention, but this is a possible explanation rather than an isolated mechanism measurement: three repeats per cell do not separate queueing, scheduling, and compute costs. The no-image controls retain smaller gaps. These M4 Pro observations complement the separately versioned integrated-build checks below.

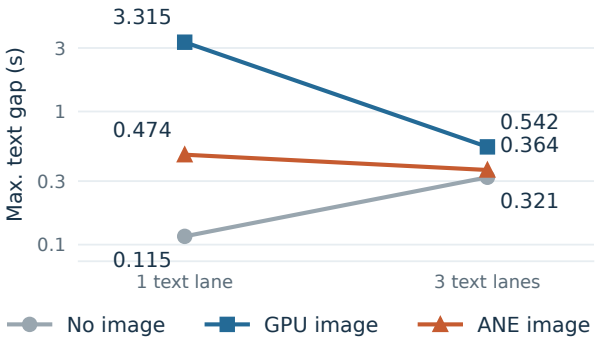


Figure 19. M4 Pro 8K-tier (8,192 patches) median maximum text-output gap in the image-arrival window (three observations per cell). All six requested-ANE cohorts actually encode on ANE. The vertical axis is logarithmic. Lower gaps describe continuity, not lower image latency.

B.8. Integrated-build regression scope

Four targeted M4 Pro checks on the integrated build pass: CPU and GPU image paths complete without GPU timeout or memory guard trips and reproduce reference outputs; 1K and 32K text controls each reproduce two recorded reference logit values bitwise and the 64 generated tokens exactly.

Table 15. M4 Pro image-arrival medians at the 8K vision tier (8,192 patches; 8,160 input patches, 2,040 image tokens). Text rate uses the fixed observation window; image time uses the packet image-ready measurement. These are descriptive cells, not confidence intervals.

Lanes	Arm	Gap (s)	Text tok/s	Image (s)
1	ane	0.474	22.80	36.91
1	gpu	3.315	15.50	32.97
1	none	0.115	30.50	–
3	ane	0.364	39.50	80.61
3	gpu	0.542	39.23	83.28
3	none	0.321	39.83	–

The image fixture is answered incorrectly by both reference and candidate, so output preservation is not an accuracy pass. Appendix B.9 extends these checks with three-device service cold recovery. The integrated M6 build also completes two large-image GPU-tower trials with language ANE enabled, a text control, and a forced 8K ANE-tower image. Its first cold-process 128K history request restores 131,040 disk KV tokens and one state snapshot, recomputes 32 tokens, and has a single observed TTFT of 1.85 s. The following branched request is in the same process: its 131,072 cached tokens include only 32 additional disk KV tokens, so it is not a second independent cold-restart observation. Both outputs match the writing process. These checks exercise the integrated execution and restoration paths.

B.9. Integrated Service: Phase Ownership and Committed History

The following experiments extend the preceding mechanism studies to the completed service path. They use the later integrated implementation, distributed as software version 2.3; JustFit v2 remains the system studied in this paper.

Phase-dependent heterogeneous execution. All three nodes execute both 4K and 8K vision tiers on ANE in their allowed phases. M4 Pro/M5 Pro admit vision ANE during GPU text prefill and decode; M6 admits it during decode without active prefill and retains GPU vision while language ANE prefill runs. Placement checks require full-ANE/no-GPU execution within the vision groups, in addition to native route counters. These checks connect the earlier forced-route diagnostics to the phase-aware service policy.

Cancellation must propagate from the request to worker ownership and payload reservations. Successful cancellation and subsequent recovery are observed on each device. The M6 test illustrates why admission and cancellation must be distinguished: its two-decode-lane cancellation attempt was denied ANE memory and ran on GPU. A subsequent one-lane interval exercised actual ANE cancellation and recovery. The one-lane test therefore supplies the ANE cancellation evidence.

Table 16. Later integrated-service cold recovery, one qualified case per device. All outputs match the respective preparation request. Each case is the first recovery request after restart.

Device	Disk KV	State hits	Reused tokens
M4 Pro	34,464	1	34,464
M5 Pro	34,464	1	34,464
M6	34,464	1	34,464

Cold composite-state restoration. A common request is prepared, the service process is restarted, and its first recovery request is checked for disk reads, state reuse, and output equality. Each device restores 34,464 disk KV tokens, hits one composite-state snapshot, and reuses 34,464 tokens; outputs match the preparation run (Table 16). The earlier 128K M5 Pro/M6 observations retain their own build and request-order identities. Section 6 identifies the remaining durability coverage.

History preservation through the frontend. State reuse also depends on the history delivered to the engine. A legacy image-request rewrite trimmed oldest messages using an approximate token count, changing the reusable prefix before native inference. The native-backend route now bypasses that legacy trimming and delegates context-limit validation to the engine. A synthetic image-bearing history sent through each M5 Pro/M6 broker contains 12,634 prompt tokens; a follow-up reuses 12,608 tokens (99.79%) and retrieves the early retained fact and image answer. The constructed history checks early-fact preservation together with prefix reuse.

A separate integrated-service retrieval set, distinct from the M6 language-ANE on/off probes in Table 5, contains four frozen development tasks per device. These tasks, at approximately 16K–34K actual input tokens, yield eight correct answers across M5 Pro/M6. M6 split counters confirm language ANE activity. One M5 Pro task resumes warm after a client interruption and is not cold-speed evidence. These development tasks extend functional retrieval coverage.

Bounded speculative output. Per-request thinking limits must survive the same frontend, protocol, and native boundaries as history. The serving control validates and propagates the budget into native request state; speculative retention respects the remaining budget, and the thinking segment closes at the cap rather than relying on a template suggestion. Bounded checks cover small caps, a 1,536-token thinking limit, streaming, tools, and concurrent requests. This validates the serving control through the inherited speculative decoder. Installation-level reproduction is described in Appendix L.

C. Mechanisms and Design Alternatives

Table 17 summarizes the transition and supporting mechanisms. The implementation inventory and measurement summaries appear in the following tables. Mechanism inclusion does not imply that every feature has an isolated end-to-end ablation.

Table 17. Mechanism coverage and measured design alternatives.

Mechanism	MLX predecessor	Native implementation and extensions
KV representation	Rotated MSE; 256-token pages; shared page references	Same compact representation; 32-token pages; native page/attention interfaces
Attention consumers	Fused inverse reconstruction; two-head grouping; explicit evaluation	One-head BF16 staging; rotated-domain verification; coalesced V layout; compact softmax
Components	Head and media leases; singleton MTP released for concurrent AR	Target/draft retained; host embedding gather; phase-scoped vision; generation-bound ownership
Workspaces	Bound lazy intermediates at evaluation boundaries	Alias disjoint intermediates; elastic prefill arena; decode-owned RoPE; shared verification rows
Transitions	Admission and output reservation; MTP/AR switch at complete rounds	Layered prefill; accepted-boundary reconciliation; adaptive width and shared-lane execution
Persistence	Borrowed page-run views; bounded atomic writer	Upstream composite snapshots, tiered storage and transfer ordering; JustFit durable ancestor retention
Speculation	Singleton MTP; concurrent AR	Learned proposals plus matching lookup tail; adaptive 8/16-row verification; selective W4A8
CrossFire	Phase-coordinated GPU text and vision	CPU-SME/GPU column partition; complete ANE vision tower; phase and memory coordination with upstream language ANE

Reproducibility. The accompanying tables preserve counts, units, timing definitions, actual routes, and per-request restore counters. The separate provenance record maps measurements to exact input, build, profile, and source-result identities. Plot scripts consume these tables directly. Failed and partial observations remain in that record; they are not converted into successful comparison cells.

D. Representation and Resource Accounting

Table 18. Representation parameters for the evaluated hybrid model. Page payload includes all attention layers, both K/V and all KV heads.

Quantity	Value
Full-attention / recurrent layers	16 / 48
KV heads / head dimension	4 / 256
Q4 indices + norm per vector	128 + 2 bytes
KV payload per retained token	16,640 bytes
MLX / native page length	256 / 32 tokens
MLX page payload	4,259,840 bytes
Native page payload	532,480 bytes

E. Four-System Speed Measurements

Table 20 supplies the numerical values plotted in Figure 1. Each rate is the median over eight SPEED-Bench tasks at 16K input and 512 output tokens. Section 4.1 specifies the speed protocol; Section 5.1 describes the separate capacity measurements.

Table 19. Resource effects from separately scoped measurements or analytical bounds. Rows are not additive reductions of a common process peak.

Mechanism	Quantity and scope	Before	After	Interpretation
Head grouping	BF16 operand, 192K (MiB)	768	384	Two of four heads at once
Head grouping	Synthetic MLX incremental peak, 192K (MiB)	3123.8	1589.3	Measured; latency +3.6%
Borrowed checkpoint	Synthetic MLX incremental peak, 224K (MiB)	3640	227.5	Cache-only save workload
Native staged head	BF16 operand, 256K (MiB)	1024	256	Analytical one-layer bound
Host embedding	Metal table residency (MiB)	682.047	0	Host mapping remains
Verification rows	Shared A8 workspace (MiB)	425.055	220.098	64-row versus 32-row allocation

Table 20. Fixed-output 16K speed medians (tokens/s). MLX-VLM* denotes the historical modified TQ4+MTP configuration.

Device	System	Prefill	Decode
M4 Pro	MLX-VLM*	123.13	13.26
M4 Pro	JustFit v1	120.89	19.43
M4 Pro	Splash 1.3.0	128.57	51.01
M4 Pro	JustFit v2	140.36	46.52
M5 Pro	MLX-VLM*	345.56	14.52
M5 Pro	JustFit v1	338.15	22.47
M5 Pro	Splash 1.3.0	403.71	57.58
M5 Pro	JustFit v2	479.64	55.51
M6	MLX-VLM*	277.14	8.17
M6	JustFit v1	273.49	18.14
M6	Splash 1.3.0	307.16	36.87
M6	JustFit v2	449.09	36.06

F. Complete Throughput and Interference Tables

Table 21. Batch matrix means with observed min–max ranges. A dash denotes an unavailable complete cell. Each completed cell has 24 cohorts.

Device	Input	B	n	Mean TG	Min TG	Max TG
M4 Pro	1K	1	24	58.03	53.06	68.31
M4 Pro	1K	2	24	61.10	56.73	65.89
M4 Pro	1K	4	24	60.35	57.38	63.96
M4 Pro	32K	1	24	40.92	35.53	49.45
M4 Pro	32K	2	24	43.32	39.59	48.62
M4 Pro	32K	4	24	43.12	38.99	47.79
M5 Pro	1K	1	24	70.52	59.69	83.65
M5 Pro	1K	2	24	107.31	89.82	121.96
M5 Pro	1K	4	24	157.53	145.22	170.87
M5 Pro	32K	1	24	56.84	45.51	74.55
M5 Pro	32K	2	24	83.84	74.81	101.31
M5 Pro	32K	4	24	111.28	103.44	120.10
M6	1K	1	24	42.29	30.60	50.50
M6	1K	2	24	69.17	50.00	85.98
M6	1K	4	24	110.79	97.21	117.42
M6	32K	1	24	34.58	27.04	41.70
M6	32K	2	24	56.60	51.62	66.83
M6	32K	4	24	81.30	74.68	96.91

Table 22. Original M5 Pro image-arrival diagnostic medians. L denotes incumbent text lanes; an image adds one request. Requested ANE includes fallback. Three observations per row; the three-lane 8K GPU cell includes the known background-compilation overlap.

Tier	L	Requested route	Actual ANE/n	Max gap (s)	Text wall (s)	Image latency (s)
8192	1	GPU	0/3	1.702	96.029	8.536
8192	1	ANE	3/3	0.425	95.288	13.155
8192	3	GPU	0/3	0.358	265.195	34.691
8192	3	ANE	2/3	0.211	264.495	33.665
14400	1	GPU	0/3	3.508	101.239	15.664
14400	1	ANE	3/3	0.398	100.818	23.137
14400	3	GPU	0/3	0.379	271.282	39.539
14400	3	ANE	3/3	0.208	269.646	37.465

Table 23. Separate uncontaminated three-text-lane controls. Both requested ANE routes have zero ANE encoding. The 8K ANE record comes from an assertion payload and is not a successful offload trial.

Tier	Requested route	Encoded	Gap (s)	Text wall (s)	Record status
8192	NONE	0	0.156	253.103	Recorded observation
8192	GPU	0	0.354	260.639	Recorded observation
8192	ANE	0	0.344	262.010	Assertion payload
14400	GPU	0	0.399	268.342	Recorded observation
14400	ANE	0	0.384	268.738	Recorded observation

G. Image-Arrival Timing Ranges

Requested and executed routes are separated. The 8K three-lane GPU control includes the documented background-compilation overlap and is not a clean control. A denied ANE request executes on GPU; its short attempted preparation interval is not ANE encoding time. Preparation remains a harness interval, and the residual to completion is not an isolated GPU stage.

Table 24. Observed minimum–maximum ranges in seconds; each row contains only one executed route. These are not confidence intervals.

Tier	L	Requested	Executed	n	Text max gap	Image completion	ANE preparation
8192	1	GPU	GPU	3	1.657–1.711	8.529–8.578	–
8192	1	ANE	ANE	3	0.425–0.426	13.147–13.267	6.210–6.332
8192	3	GPU	GPU	3	0.328–0.391	34.295–34.740	–
8192	3	ANE	GPU	1	0.334–0.334	34.587–34.587	–
8192	3	ANE	ANE	2	0.175–0.211	33.407–33.665	6.285–6.310
14400	1	GPU	GPU	3	3.503–3.531	15.660–15.714	–
14400	1	ANE	ANE	3	0.398–0.398	22.678–23.151	15.492–15.581
14400	3	GPU	GPU	3	0.372–0.427	39.131–39.902	–
14400	3	ANE	ANE	3	0.192–0.546	37.121–38.038	15.493–15.581

H. Restart Boundary Measurements

Table 25. Original-history H restart observations with a 128 GiB disk quota, separate from the M5 Pro/M6 2 GiB speed matrices. Prompt length, rather than a nominal case label, determines the boundary interpretation. Exact means byte-identical output within the paired comparison, not a semantic correctness score.

Device	Retention	Prompt	Cached	Recomputed	Disk KV	TTFT (s)	Exact
M5 Pro	Baseline	16384	0	16384	0	31.14	Yes
M5 Pro	Deep ancestor	16384	0	16384	0	31.08	Yes
M5 Pro	Baseline	32736	0	32736	0	68.79	Yes
M5 Pro	Deep ancestor	32736	0	32736	0	68.68	Yes

Device	Retention	Prompt	Cached	Recomputed	Disk KV	TTFT (s)	Exact
M5 Pro	Baseline	32768	0	32768	0	68.57	Yes
M5 Pro	Deep ancestor	32768	0	32768	0	68.59	Yes
M5 Pro	Baseline	32800	0	32800	0	68.66	Yes
M5 Pro	Deep ancestor	32800	32768	32	32768	0.62	Yes
M5 Pro	Baseline	131072	0	131072	0	445.38	Yes
M5 Pro	Deep ancestor	131072	131040	32	131040	1.90	Yes
M6	Deep ancestor	16025	16000	25	16000	0.54	Yes
M6	Baseline	16025	16000	25	16000	0.55	Yes
M6	Deep ancestor	32612	0	32612	0	81.06	Yes
M6	Baseline	32612	0	32612	0	80.61	Yes
M6	Deep ancestor	33011	32992	19	32992	0.75	Yes
M6	Baseline	33011	0	33011	0	82.29	Yes
M6	Deep ancestor	131072	131040	32	131040	1.86	Yes
M6	Baseline	131072	0	131072	0	582.91	Yes

The cold-restart table counts only the first request in each fresh process. Subsequent requests can reuse resident pages without additional disk reads. The continuation-first control tests ten combinations of five lengths and two retention policies, separating cold restoration from this in-process reuse.

I. Design Alternatives and Experimental Boundaries

Table 26. Measured alternatives and what their outcomes resolve.

Alternative	Observation	Design implication
Wider verification	204.957 MiB more shared workspace; 32K B3 +0.798%, B4 -0.321% TG.	Keep the smaller row budget for this context-first workload.
Elastic prefill arena alone	Initial cold B2 capacity does not improve; the limiting phase still needs the arena.	Planner headroom is not measured usable capacity.
Prefill-only A8	Historical PP 370.21 to 487.25 tokens/s, wall 96.62 to 76.49 s; natural TG -12.4%.	Measure generated work and verify separately; not a combined-A8 ablation.
Residual quantization	Sampled output RMS 0.05695 (4-bit), 0.13608 (3+1-bit), 0.06726 (4+1-bit).	These tested layouts do not improve the sampled reference error.
Oversized ANE graph	Padding still executes dense capacity-sized attention.	Select the smallest supported tier that fits original geometry.
Oldest-first restart under pressure	Six exact outputs but no restore in the recorded small-quota sequence.	Output correctness does not establish cache-survivor coverage.
128K partial-overlap scheduling	Incumbent output finishes before prefill, leaving an uncontended tail.	Exclude that row from matched full-overlap comparisons; extend incumbent output.

Residual-layout scope. The residual study uses six captured attention sets, eight construction seeds and final query row 2,047. The three layouts use 130, 132 and 164 bytes per 256-dimensional vector. This is an offline operator screen, not a public task score or a rejection of all residual quantizers. TurboQuant's QJL residual targets unbiased inner-product estimation (Zandieh et al., 2026); unbiasedness does not guarantee smaller squared error, particularly after nonlinear attention. The observed RMS ordering therefore does not itself diagnose a bug or establish the cause in this implementation.

J. Persistent-Storage Accounting

Budget-accounted bytes must be distinguished from filesystem occupancy. After pressure, the 1 GiB control reports 1,073,594,368 accounted bytes, but 1,269,707,008 logical file bytes and 1,080,827,904 allocated bytes. The KV slot file is sparse: its logical length is 1,073,233,920 bytes while only 878,051,328 bytes are allocated; released slots can be hole-punched without shortening the file. Logical length must not be interpreted as physical SSD occupancy. Total allocated storage exceeds 1 GiB by about 6.76 MiB. The 7,233,536-byte difference between allocated and budget-accounted storage decomposes into 6,291,456 bytes of state-slot allocation slack, 540,672 bytes of KV-slot slack, and 401,408 bytes for records files. This reconciles the observed snapshot. The configured quota is therefore not an exact cap on total filesystem

allocation in this observation. In each 128 GiB restart group, the corresponding counts are 3,003,252,736 accounted bytes, 3,004,049,152 logical bytes, and 3,021,840,384 allocated bytes. These measurements demonstrate survivor recovery and quantify the observed accounting overhead.

K. Recorded Coding-Agent Case

Task and execution. Figure 2 uses a recorded Token Garden task: recreate a supplied low-poly garden image as a procedural Three.js scene, including the stream, bridge, cherry tree, torii gate, rocks, stepping stones, petals and title. The three runs execute sequentially on the same M5 Pro (16-core GPU, 24 GiB) with dsh 0.2.1-rc.2, the same initial prompt, reference, tool interface and fresh seeded workspace. The agent writes code and inspects browser screenshots. Calls enable thinking with medium reasoning effort, temperature 1.0, top-p 0.95 and top-k 20. The configured per-call output allowance is 32,768 tokens; compaction and auxiliary calls can use smaller limits. Each run has a four-hour wall-time cap.

Whole-system configurations. V1 uses MLX, MXFP4 target weights, TQ4 KV and its MTP draft. Splash 1.3.0 and v2 use the same packed four-bit target layout and DFlash2 draft; Splash uses INT8 KV and v2 uses TQ4, prefill/verification A8 and context lookup. Both native arms configure a 21,631 MiB allocation budget and 16 GiB persistent-cache quota; v2 sets 128 MiB host reserve. Language ANE is disabled in both native arms. These recorded development configurations are distinct from later software-installation qualification. The comparison concerns the assembled systems, including their numerical paths and decoders.

Compaction and context accounting. The configured windows are 262,144 tokens for v1/v2 and 65,529 for Splash. The agent's trigger is $\lfloor \min(0.9W, W - 32{,}768) \rfloor$, yielding 229,376 and 32,761 tokens, respectively. This is an agent policy for the recorded settings. Session logs record zero compaction starts for v1/v2 and 31 for Splash. Context in the figure is the input-plus-output token count reported after a model call; K labels in this figure use decimal thousands. The last completed calls contain 145,149 tokens for v1, 29,197 for Splash and 163,038 for v2. The terminal horizontal segments hold these last observations to the run end; they are not additional model calls.

Snapshots and stopping. The first snapshot row is taken near 66 minutes of elapsed runtime in each run, rather than at the same absolute clock time. The second row uses the capped runs' final captures and repeats v2's last recorded frame, labeled with its earlier run end. V1's recorded page remains blank at the first row; its first nonblank recorded render occurs at approximately 77 minutes. The v2 driver records task return at 3,956.489 seconds and run end at 3,977.311 seconds (1:06:17), including final browser recording. V1 and Splash reach the wall-time cap while still active. These are agent-controlled stopping events, not independently graded task completion or a visual-quality ranking. The figure illustrates one retained trajectory per system; later exploratory reruns and follow-up prompts are separate records, not repeated trials pooled into this comparison.

L. Artifact Identity and Bounded Reproduction

Three evidence layers. The performance tables identify their own runtime, profile and workload cohorts. Historical integrated-service checks use the 2.3.0rc14 software reference; later staging and capacity checks retain distinct native identities. The public software series is JustFit 2.3, available at `https://github.com/YuhuaBillChen/justfit-llm` and `https://pypi.org/project/justfit-llm/`. A later installation check does not rerun or relabel a historical performance measurement.

The experiment provenance records distinguish historical service inputs, runtime revisions and installation artifacts by their SHA256 identities. The manuscript source archive contains the typesetting inputs and figures; it does not include private audit receipts. Compiler output is not assumed to be universally deterministic.

Installation validation. The historical 2.3.0rc24 preview pins 498 project files; its wheel, source archive and sdist contain the same 499-member project tree including the manifest. On each evaluated Mac, the qualified local distributions pass 113 source tests, 15 service tests and 30 installation/lifecycle checks. A shared prebuilt runtime is installed without receiver compilation, followed by text, two synthetic images, an eight-token thinking budget, streaming and cold-restart checks. Each restart case restores 8,704 disk KV tokens with one state hit and equal outputs. These checks have a smaller workload than the earlier 34,464-token service cases and do not replace them. A fresh M5 Pro environment additionally installs the public

TestPyPI package, verifies its source contents, and passes the installation and runtime checks. The subsequent 2.3.0 release uses a Developer ID-signed and notarized runtime; a fresh M5 Pro environment also passes the formal PyPI installation and runtime checks. These release checks preserve the distinction between installation validation and the earlier performance cohorts.

Precompiled ANE assets. Two device-specific 4K/8K graph-and-cache archives per evaluated configuration are restored into an initially empty simulated user cache through the HTTPS installer, with certificate verification enabled. On each device, both complete towers produce BF16 outputs byte-identical to their qualified references; every tower executes nine full-ANE/no-GPU groups. The 90 compiled files remain unchanged during loading and execution. Automatic phase-aware routing, memory admission and fallback are tested separately from forced-route timing studies. These receipts cover the exact evaluated chips and macOS 27.0.1 build 26A434, not portability across arbitrary chips, OS builds or compiler revisions. A simulated fresh cache is not a factory-clean machine. The JustFit 2.3 GitHub releases distribute the runtime and device-specific ANE archives.

Installed graph assets and compiled file sets are checked against their SHA256 manifests before reuse and automatic-profile startup. Negative regression cases reject modified content even when size and modification time are preserved, missing or extra files, links and special files, without overwriting the user's cache. The default trust model still trusts local processes with the same user identity; these checks are not a sandbox against a concurrent malicious writer.

Scope. Synthetic dashboard and geometric fixtures avoid disclosing private screenshots; their expected answers and routing checks do not substitute for natural-image quality evaluation. Software tests, dependency checks and negative-input regressions provide bounded reproducibility evidence. They are not a complete native-code audit, fuzzing campaign or independent penetration test, and do not establish absence of vulnerabilities. Installation validation and performance measurement retain their separate workload scopes.